Distributional Learning of Multiple Context-Free Languages under Fixed Finite-Semigroup Typing: Local Groups and the Length of Characteristic Data

Takayuki Kuriyama
Independent Researcher, Tokyo, Japan
growup.kuriyama@gmail.com

Abstract

We study the positive data needed to learn multiple context-free languages when constituents are compared only if they agree under a typing fixed in advance, a morphism onto a finite semigroup. Identification in the limit follows from Yoshinaka's framework; we bound the total length of characteristic samples by the size and rule thickness of a target grammar, and ask for which typings this length is polynomial. If the typing is onto a local group, a finite semigroup S in which $e\mathsf{S}e$ is a group for every idempotent e, then for every fixed fan-out and rank, length quadratic in grammar size and linear in rule thickness suffices, and these classes are identifiable in polynomial time and thick data. The proof shortens interleaved tuple components simultaneously while preserving ordered products in noncommutative groups. Non-context-free targets of fan-out two separate the typing regimes: one lies in the class of a local-group typing but of no typing combining a bounded window with a group morphism, another in the class of such a typing only for noncommutative groups. In the worst case, length linear in grammar size times rule thickness is necessary under every typing over sufficiently large alphabets, as witnessed by explicit finite targets. At fan-out one and rank at least two, local groups are exactly the boundary: a pseudovariety yields polynomial data for all its typings if and only if it consists of local groups; otherwise some targets need samples exponentially longer than their grammars, for every set-driven learner with characteristic samples throughout the class. The boundary at fan-out two is open; the fan-out-one lower-bound family provably does not lift.

1 Introduction

Positive-data grammatical inference asks how languages can be identified from positive examples [1,2]. Distributional learning identifies constituents by shared contexts, from substitutable CFGs to discontinuous MCFGs [3, 12–14, 28]. Yoshinaka's finite-signature framework [15] provides polynomially many characteristic words, but not necessarily words of polynomial length. We therefore study their total encoded length $\|K\|_+ = \sum_{w\in K}(|w|+1)$, in the thick-data sense of [10], and ask which fixed comparison biases make it polynomial.

Setting. Fix a fan-out bound f and a surjective finite-semigroup typing $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$, chosen before seeing the target. The class $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ consists of f-MCFLs whose nonempty tuple components are substitutable when their s-types match (Definition 2.8). This class-level typing bias [5] differs from control-set and factor-local biases [6, 7, 9, 11]. The typed reconstruction operators are $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ and its rule-rank-capped variant $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ (Definition 3.4). A target has a reduced good MCFG G of

size $\|G\|$ and rule thickness $\bar{\theta}_G$, the maximum over rules of the shortest sentence using that rule (Definition 2.6). The thickness t_G of [10, 23] obeys $t_G \le \theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$ (Lemma 4.1).

Typing enlarges the identifiable class: at fan-out two, a $\mathbb{Z}_2$-typing admits a non-context-free target outside the untyped class (Proposition 3.18). The data cost is that every realized type must occur in a characteristic sample (Proposition 4.6).

Local groups. A finite semigroup is a *local group* if $e\mathsf{S}e$ is a group for every idempotent e. The pseudovariety **LG** consists precisely of finite semigroups without a copy of the two-element semilattice $U_1 = \{1, \zeta\}$ (Theorem B.4). It properly contains $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$: the parity of occurrences of `ab` is an **LG**-typing not determined by any prefix–suffix window together with a finite-group morphism (Proposition B.6).

Main results. In Theorems A and B the alphabet Σ and the fan-out f are fixed.

Theorem A (Local groups)**.** *Let $r_{\max} \ge 1$ and suppose $s(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG}$. For every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ and every reduced good presentation G of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ of fan-out $\le f$ and rank $\le r_{\max}$, the operators $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ have a common characteristic sample for L of total length $O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$; the constant depends only on f, $r_{\max}$, s and Σ (Theorem 5.7).*

Non-CFL fan-out-two targets distinguish the typing regimes of Theorem A: one is covered by a local-group typing but by no window–group typing, and another by a window–S_3 typing but by no window–abelian typing (Propositions 5.9, 5.10). These are separations of *class coverage*, not claims that a particular shortening method is necessary.

Theorem B (The linear factor)**.** (i) *Suppose that Σ has at least $4f + 1$ letters, or that $f = 1$ and Σ has at least two letters. Then for every typing s there are finite targets in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, with rank-two presentations G within a factor $7f + 17$ of the size of the smallest reduced good ones, whose characteristic samples all have length $\Omega(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r}_{f,s}$ ($r \ge 1$) and for every set-driven operator with characteristic samples throughout the class (Proposition 6.1).*

(ii) *For the trivial typing and reduced good presentations of rank $\le r_{\max}$, the operator $\mathcal{B}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$ satisfies Yoshinaka's bound $O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ [14]; if $r_{\max} \ge 2$ and the alphabet condition of* (i) *holds, the bound is attained up to a constant factor by the targets of* (i) *(Corollary 6.2).*

Theorem C (The boundary at fan-out one)**.** *Let $f = 1$ and $r_{\max} \ge 2$.*

(i) *A pseudovariety $\mathbf{V}$ of finite semigroups is contained in* **LG** *if and only if it has* uniform polynomial characteristic-data length *(Definition 7.2): for every nonempty alphabet Σ and every typing s with $s(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{V}$ there is a polynomial p, which may depend on s and Σ but not on the target, such that every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s}$ has a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{1,s}$ of length at most $p(\|G\|, \bar{\theta}_G)$ for each reduced good presentation G of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ of rank $\le r_{\max}$ (Theorem 7.3).*

(ii) *Outside* **LG** *the failure is exponential: for a typing s_U of three letters onto U_1 there are targets $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$ with reduced good rank-two presentations of size and rule thickness $O(n)$ whose characteristic samples all have length at least $3 \cdot 2^n - 1 \ge 2^{(\|G_n\| + \bar{\theta}_{G_n})/17}$ for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{1,s_U}$ and for every set-driven operator with characteristic samples throughout the class (Theorem 7.3). So the data length is either $O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$ for all typings into $\mathbf{V}$, or exponential in $\|G\| + \bar{\theta}_G$ for some of them; no intermediate growth occurs.*

For **LG**, the bound yields identification in polynomial time and thick data at every fan-out (Corollary 7.6); at fan-out one the pseudovariety boundary is exact. Since fan-out one is CFG, Theorem C strengthens the sufficient condition from the companion [23] and provides the benchmark for Theorem A.

The remaining question. Whether **LG** is also the boundary for $f \geq 2$ remains open (Open Problem 9.1). The exponential family of Theorem C cannot settle it: under every fixed typing its sufficiently large members leave the fan-out-two class (Theorem 8.2).

Approach. Refining a grammar by types can make it exponentially thicker (Proposition 4.7), so our bounds use the original presentation. A subtree contributes up to f separated blocks, possibly interleaved in different orders with blocks from other subtrees; noncommutative products preclude independent shortening. Instead we preserve the ordered product of each component through simultaneous block replacement (Proposition 5.2). For local groups, unchanged buffer letters protect factors crossing block boundaries (Lemma B.7). Lower bounds use families closed under taking subsets (Proposition 6.1) and rare realized types (Proposition 4.6).

Relation to prior work. Yoshinaka developed the qualitative reconstruction and identification framework for CFGs and MCFGs [12–15]; finite local-group structure is classical [34–36]. Our contribution is the analysis of total sample *length* and its boundary. Related learning models appear in [16, 18–20]; the substitution lemma of [21] is a membership, not a learning, criterion.

Relation to the companion CFG manuscript. The companion [23] proves window–group bounds and a U_1-typing lower bound at fan-out one. Here **LG** gives the all-fan-out upper bound and the exact fan-out-one pseudovariety boundary. Table 1 distinguishes contributions. The three-letter doubling family is proved independently in Appendix G; we use no companion theorem.

Table 1: Relation to the companion CFG paper [23].

Topic	Companion (fan-out one)	Present paper
Qualitative learning	Typed CFG reconstruction and witnesses	Typed MCFG reconstruction; qualitative parts credited to Yoshinaka
Positive upper bound	**LI** $\vee$ **Grp**	All-fan-out **LG** and simultaneous noncommutative shortening (Theorem A)
Exponential lower bound	Five-letter bracketed U_1 family	Three-letter variant and the exact $f = 1$ pseudovariety boundary (Theorem C)
MCFG-specific results	CFG examples	Non-CFL typing separations (Propositions 3.18, 5.9, 5.10)
Additional bounds	No all-fan-out linear factor	All-fan-out linear factor and fan-out-two non-lifting (Theorems B, 8.2)

Scope of the claims. All bounds concern encoded sample length relative to the stated presentation and fixed typing, not grammar minimization or a Gold convergence stage. Table 2 records operator, rank and alphabet conditions.

Organization. Sections 2–4 fix reconstruction and data bounds; Sections 5–7 prove Theorems A–C. Section 8 and the conclusion address the boundary question, with technical proofs in the appendices.

2 Preliminaries

Throughout, Σ is a finite alphabet, ε the empty word and $\Sigma^+ := \Sigma^* \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$. If $\Sigma = \emptyset$, the only languages are $\emptyset$ and $\{\varepsilon\}$ and are handled directly. For a finite $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$ put $\|K\|_+ := \sum_{w \in K}(|w|+1)$, and for a tuple $\vec{u} = (u_1, \ldots, u_d)$ put $\|\vec{u}\|_1 := \sum_i |u_i|$. Every polynomial bound below states whether it concerns cardinality or $\|\cdot\|_+$. We use G for a reduced good presentation and G_{in} for an arbitrary input grammar; $\|G\|$, θ_G and t_G denote its encoding size, rule thickness and nonterminal thickness. The fresh-identity completion of s is $\widehat{s}$. Section 4 defines the shortest typed yield t_{typ}, representative length τ and shortest realized type length μ_m, none of which is rule thickness.

2.1 Positive-Data Learning

Definition 2.1 (Text, TxtEx identification, conservativeness)**.** Fix a pause symbol $\perp \notin \Sigma$. A *text* for $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is an infinite sequence over $L \cup \{\perp\}$ in which every element of L occurs; the *content* of a finite prefix is the set of elements of Σ^* occurring in it. A *learner* is a computable map from finite prefixes to grammars. It *TxtEx-identifies* L [1] if on every text for L its outputs are, from some stage on, one fixed grammar H with $L(H) = L$; it TxtEx-identifies a class if it does so for each member. It is *conservative* if it changes its hypothesis only on a datum $w \in \Sigma^*$ not generated by the current hypothesis. We fix a hypothesis H_0 with $L(H_0) = \emptyset$.

Definition 2.2 (Set-driven operator and characteristic sample)**.** A *set-driven reconstruction operator* $\mathcal{B}$ maps each finite $K \subseteq \Sigma^*$ to a grammar $\mathcal{B}(K)$ depending only on the set K; it is *sample-consistent* if $K \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$ for all K. A finite $\mathcal{F} \subseteq L$ is a *characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}$ and L* if $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) = L$ for every finite K with $\mathcal{F} \subseteq K \subseteq L$ (cf. [4]).

The definition constrains generated languages only: $\mathcal{B}(K)$ need not stabilize syntactically as K grows.

2.2 Fixed Finite-Semigroup Typing

Definition 2.3 (Typing, fresh completion, refinement)**.** A *typing* is a surjective semigroup morphism $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ onto a finite semigroup, given by the multiplication table of S and the images of the letters, so that $s(w)$ is computable in time $O(|w|)$; S is its *positive image*. (A morphism into a larger finite semigroup is replaced by its corestriction to the image.) Let $\mathsf{S}^\sharp := \mathsf{S} \uplus \{\mathbf{1}_\sharp\}$ be obtained by adjoining a *fresh* identity, even if S already has one, and let $\widehat{s} : \Sigma^* \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ be the monoid morphism with $\widehat{s}(\varepsilon) = \mathbf{1}_\sharp$ and $\widehat{s}|_{\Sigma^+} = s$. For $\vec{w} \in (\Sigma^*)^d$ put $\widehat{s}^{(d)}(\vec{w}) := (\widehat{s}(w_1), \ldots, \widehat{s}(w_d))$; on $(\Sigma^+)^d$ this is $s^{(d)}(\vec{w})$. For typings s, s' write $s \preceq s'$ if $\ker s' \subseteq \ker s$ on Σ^+, and let (s, s') be the typing $w \mapsto (s(w), s'(w))$ onto its image in $\mathsf{S} \times \mathsf{T}$, where $\mathsf{T} := s'(\Sigma^+)$; thus $s, s' \preceq (s, s')$. Write s_{triv} for the one-element typing.

The fresh completion evaluates grammar templates (including empty terminal gaps) and types tuple yields in the refinement of Section 3.2; its new identity is not a positive-word type. Algebraic conditions such as **LG** concern S, not $\mathsf{S}^\sharp$; indeed $\mathsf{S}^\sharp$ is never a local group, since $\{\mathbf{1}_\sharp, e\} \cong U_1$ for any idempotent e of the minimal ideal of S. A finite-monoid morphism $q : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ determines the positive typing $q|_{\Sigma^+}$: by Lemma E.1(i), it gives the same target class and set-driven reconstruction rules as the fresh completion of that typing. Lemma E.1(ii) additionally identifies their trimmed yield-type refinements for *good* grammars. This last identification is not asserted for arbitrary standard grammars with empty-component yields.

Definition 2.4 (Prefix–suffix typing)**.** For $k, \ell \geq 0$ put $m_0 := \max\{1, k+\ell\}$, and for $|w| \geq m_0$ let $\mathrm{pref}_k(w)$, $\mathrm{suf}_\ell(w)$ be the prefix and suffix of the indicated lengths (length-zero windows are ε). Define

$$\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(w) = \begin{cases} w, & |w| < m_0, \\ \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(w), \mathrm{suf}_\ell(w) \rangle, & |w| \geq m_0, \end{cases}$$

with disjoint tags for short words and pairs, and put $M_{k,\ell} := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\Sigma^*)$. For short x, y and pairs $\langle u, v \rangle, \langle u', v' \rangle$ define

$$x \cdot y := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(xy), \qquad x \cdot \langle u, v \rangle := \langle \mathrm{pref}_k(xu), v \rangle,$$
$$\langle u, v \rangle \cdot y := \langle u, \mathrm{suf}_\ell(vy) \rangle, \quad \langle u, v \rangle \cdot \langle u', v' \rangle := \langle u, v' \rangle.$$

Put $s_{k,\ell} := \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}|_{\Sigma^+}$; a typing s with $s \preceq s_{k,\ell}$ for some $k, \ell \geq 0$ is a *window typing*.

A case check on the lengths of $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ gives $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(xy) = \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(x) \cdot \widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(y)$. Since $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is onto $M_{k,\ell}$, the product is associative and $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\varepsilon)$ is an identity, so $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is a finite-monoid morphism. The short-word tag separates ε from $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(\Sigma^+)$, so $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ is isomorphic to the completion $\widehat{s_{k,\ell}}$.

2.3 Multiple Context-Free Grammars

Definition 2.5 (Standard MCFG presentation and size)**.** An MCFG [28, 29] is $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ with finite V, $S \in V$, $\mathrm{fan}(S) = 1$ and $\mathrm{fan}(A) \geq 1$. A rule of rank $r \geq 0$ is $A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$ with template $\rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$, $d_0 = \mathrm{fan}(A)$, $d_j = \mathrm{fan}(B_j)$, where each α_i is a word over $\Gamma_\rho := \Sigma \uplus \Xi_1 \uplus \cdots \uplus \Xi_r$, $\Xi_j := \{\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}\}$, and every variable occurs at most once in $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_{d_0}$ (*linearity*). For $\vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_j}$, $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)$ substitutes $u_{j,\kappa}$ for ξ_j^κ; for $r = 0$ the rule is a *constant rule*. The tuple languages $L_A(G) \subseteq (\Sigma^*)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$ form the least family closed under the rules, and $L(G) := \{w : (w) \in L_S(G)\}$. We write $A \Rightarrow_G^* \vec{u}$ for a *terminal derivation* (a finite derivation tree rooted at A, evaluated bottom-up); one from S is *successful*. G is an f-MCFG if $\mathrm{fan}(A) \leq f$ for all A, and has rule-rank cap $r_{\max}$ if all ranks are at most $r_{\max}$. Such a presentation, with no further restriction, is called *standard*. Its *size* is

$$\|G\| := |V| + \sum_{(A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)) \in P} \Big(1 + r + \textstyle\sum_i |\alpha_i|\Big),$$

where $|\alpha_i|$ counts terminal and variable occurrences. All bounds use this symbol-level size; a bit-level encoding with binary nonterminal names changes it by at most a factor $O(\log \|G\|)$.

$\mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$ is the class of languages of MCFGs of fan-out $\leq f$ and rule rank $\leq r$; f-MCFL $= \bigcup_{r<\infty} \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$, and the minimum rule rank of a language is taken over all its fan-out-$\leq f$ presentations. For nonterminals of equal fan-out d, $A \to B$ abbreviates $A \to (\xi_1^1, \ldots, \xi_1^d)(B)$, and $A \to \vec{c}$ a constant rule. Rule variables are always ξ_j^κ; terminals in examples are in `typewriter` font. Fan-out and rank are distinct resources. At fixed fan-out at least two the rule-rank hierarchy does not collapse in general, although adjacent levels can coincide; in particular $\mathsf{MCFL}(2, 2) = \mathsf{MCFL}(2, 3)$ [22, 31]. By contrast, fan-out-one CFGs can be binarized. The reconstruction below therefore assumes neither a binary normal form nor a known rank cap.

Definition 2.6 (Grammar properties)**.** A rule is *nondeleting* if every variable occurs exactly once in its template; a nondeleting rule is *nonpermuting* if for each j the variables $\xi_j^1, \ldots, \xi_j^{d_j}$ occur in this order in $\alpha_1 \cdots \alpha_{d_0}$, and *nonmerging* if moreover no α_i contains a factor $\xi_j^\kappa \xi_j^{\kappa+1}$. Following [14, Section 2.3], a rule is *ε-free* ("λ-free" there) if no α_i is empty. A rule, template or

grammar is *good* if it is ε-free, nondeleting, nonpermuting and nonmerging. A nonterminal A is *reachable* if there is a chain $S = A_0, \dots, A_m = A$ in which each A_{i+1} is a child in a rule for A_i, and *productive* if $L_A(G) \neq \emptyset$; G is *reduced* if every nonterminal is both.

In a ε-free grammar every component of every derived tuple is nonempty (induction on derivations). ε-freeness concerns template components and is distinct from $\varepsilon \notin L(G)$.

2.4 Tuple Contexts and Substitutability

A *sentence context of arity d* is a word $E = v_0 \Box_1 v_1 \cdots v_{d-1} \Box_d v_d$ with each hole occurring once, $v_0, v_d \in \Sigma^*$ and $v_1, \dots, v_{d-1} \in \Sigma^+$; $\mathcal{E}_d$ is the set of these *admissible* contexts [14, Section 3.1]. $E[\vec{w}]$ fills $\Box_i$ by w_i, $|E|_{\text{fix}} := \sum_{i=0}^{d} |v_i|$, and E *accepts* $\vec{w}$ in L if $E[\vec{w}] \in L$. The *d-tuple distribution* of $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^*)^d$ is $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) := \{E \in \mathcal{E}_d : E[\vec{x}] \in L\}$; at fan-out one it is the two-sided distribution $\{(u, v) : uxv \in L\}$.

Definition 2.7 (Tuple occurrence)**.** For $w = a_1 \cdots a_n$ number the cut positions $⓪a_1① \cdots a_n⓷$ and write $w[i : i'] := a_{i+1} \cdots a_{i'}$. An *arity-$d$ tuple occurrence* in w is a sequence $0 \le i_1 < i'_1 < i_2 < i'_2 < \cdots < i_d < i'_d \le n$; it determines $\vec{x} = (w[i_1 : i'_1], \dots, w[i_d : i'_d]) \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ and the context $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ obtained by replacing these intervals by $\Box_1, \dots, \Box_d$, so that $E[\vec{x}] = w$. For finite K, $\text{Obs}_d(K) := \{\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^+)^d : E[\vec{x}] \in K \text{ for some } E \in \mathcal{E}_d\}$ is the set of tuples arising from such occurrences, and for a fixed fan-out bound $f \ge 1$, put $\text{Obs}(K) := \bigcup_{1 \le d \le f} \text{Obs}_d(K)$.

Definition 2.8 ((f, s)-tuple substitutability and the target class)**.** Let $f \ge 1$ and let s be a typing. A language $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is *(f, s)-tuple-substitutable* if for every $1 \le d \le f$ and all $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$,

$$s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \;\text{ and }\; \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) \cap \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}) \neq \emptyset \implies \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y}).$$

$\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$ is the class of (f, s)-tuple-substitutable f-MCFLs. For $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ write $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s}^{d} \vec{y}$ (or $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{y}$) if $s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and $\mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = \mathcal{D}_L^{(d)}(\vec{y})$; this is an equivalence relation.

Empty components are never compared, following [14, Section 3.1 and footnote 3] (see [8] for CFGs), and $\varepsilon \in L$ is handled at the start symbol; otherwise already a^+ would fail, since a and ε share a context but not their distributions. The bias consists of both s and f:

(a) If $s \preceq s'$, equal s'-types are equal s-types, so $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,s'}^{\text{mcf}}$; in particular $\mathcal{C}_{f,s_{\text{triv}}}^{\text{mcf}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$. This compares classes only: the operators $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s'}$ of Section 3 differ in general (they coincide when $\ker s = \ker s'$).

(b) $\mathcal{C}_{f+1,s}^{\text{mcf}} \cap f\text{-MCFL} \subseteq \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$, but the class is not monotone in f: for the trivial typing $\{w\#w^R : w \in \{\mathsf{a}, \mathsf{b}\}^*\}$ is 1- but not 2-dimensionally substitutable [14, Section 3.1, Example 5].

(c) For every $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^\sharp$, $\widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$: it is regular, and componentwise equal types give equal total types in every context.

Proposition 2.9 (Intersection and abelian filtering)**.** *Fix f and s.*

(i) If L_1, L_2 are (f, s)-tuple-substitutable, so is $L_1 \cap L_2$.

(ii) If L is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable, A is an abelian group, $g : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{A}$ a monoid morphism, $\mathsf{H} \le \mathsf{A}$ and $\gamma \in \mathsf{A}$, then $L \cap g^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable.

(iii) If $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$, $\mathsf{Acc} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ and, in (ii), A is finite, then $L \cap \widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc}) \cap g^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H}) \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\text{mcf}}$.

For infinite A *the intersection in (ii) belongs to* $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ *whenever it is an* f*-MCFL.*

Proof. (i) A context accepting equal-type $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ in $L_1 \cap L_2$ accepts both in each L_i, so their distributions agree in each L_i, hence in the intersection. (ii) If some context E accepts $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ in $g^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$, then $\delta := \sum_i (g(y_i) - g(x_i)) \in \mathsf{H}$, and by commutativity $g(E'[\vec{y}]) - g(E'[\vec{x}]) = \delta$ for every $E' \in \mathcal{E}_d$, so coset membership transfers in both directions. Thus $g^{-1}(\gamma + \mathsf{H})$ is (f, s_{triv})-, hence (f, s)-tuple-substitutable; apply (i). (iii) The language $\widehat{s}^{-1}(\mathsf{Acc})$ is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable by item (c) above, so the intersection is, by (i) and (ii); it is the intersection of an f-MCFL with a regular language, hence an f-MCFL [28]. □

The factorizations in (ii) and (iii) are a tool for constructing members of the class; they are not supplied to the reconstruction.

3 Reconstruction and Qualitative Learning

This section instantiates Yoshinaka's finite-signature reconstruction [15] for s-refined MCFG tuple sorts. Our soundness, completeness, exact-reconstruction and Gold-identification claims (Propositions 3.10, 3.11, Theorem 3.13, Corollary 3.16) are qualitative analogues of [15, Lemmas 2–3 and Theorem 1], not new results. Appendices D and E prove them directly for the concrete grammar; a sample-dependent rank cap handles unbounded minimum rank. Here the new question concerns total word length, rather than the finite-signature bound on the number of words.

3.1 Set-Driven Reconstruction

All interaction between templates and contexts rests on one observation.

Lemma 3.1 (Induced child contexts)**.** *Let* $\rho = (\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})$ *be a good template of rank* r *with child arities* $d_1, \ldots, d_r$*, let* $E \in \mathcal{E}_{d_0}$*, let* $1 \le j \le r$*, and fix* $\vec{u}_i \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_i}$ *for* $i \ne j$*. Let* E_j *be the word obtained from* $E[(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0})]$ *by replacing* ξ^{κ}_j *by* $\square_\kappa$ *and every other variable* $\xi^{\kappa'}_i$ *by* $u_{i,\kappa'}$*. Then* $E_j \in \mathcal{E}_{d_j}$ *and* $E_j[\vec{x}] = E[\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_{j-1}, \vec{x}, \vec{u}_{j+1}, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)]$ *for every* $\vec{x} \in (\Sigma^*)^{d_j}$*.*

Lemma 3.2 (Composition preserves equivalence)**.** *Let* $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$*, let* ρ *be a good template of rank* r*, and let* $\vec{x}_j, \vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_j}$ *satisfy* $\vec{u}_j \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}_j$ *for every* j*. Then* $\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r) \equiv_{L,s} \rho(\vec{x}_1, \ldots, \vec{x}_r)$*.*

Definition 3.3 (Composition witness)**.** Let K be finite and $r \ge 1$. A *composition witness of rank* r in K is a triple $(\vec{z}, \rho, (\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r))$ in which ρ is a good template of rank r with output arity $d_0 \le f$ and child arities $d_1, \ldots, d_r \le f$, $\vec{z} \in \mathrm{Obs}_{d_0}(K)$, $\vec{u}_j \in (\Sigma^+)^{d_j}$, and $\vec{z} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)$.

Equivalently, a composition witness is a segmentation of the components of an observed $\vec{z}$ into terminal gaps and nonempty intervals labelled by variables, subject to the good-template conditions. If $E[\vec{z}] \in K$, Lemma 3.1 gives $E_j[\vec{u}_j] = E[\vec{z}] \in K$ with E_j admissible, so every $\vec{u}_j \in \mathrm{Obs}(K)$. The children occupy disjoint, nonempty parts of $\vec{z}$, so

$$r \le \textstyle\sum_j \|\vec{u}_j\|_1 \le \|\vec{z}\|_1 \le \max_{w \in K} |w| \le \|K\|_+. \tag{3.1}$$

Definition 3.4 (Capped and uncapped reconstruction operators)**.** Fix f and a typing s. For $r_{\max} \ge 1$ let $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}(K) = \widehat{G}_{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ be the grammar with start symbol $\widehat{S}$, a nonterminal $[\vec{x}]$ of arity d for each $\vec{x} \in \mathrm{Obs}_d(K)$, $1 \le d \le f$, and the rules

(Start) $\widehat{S} \to [(w)]$ for $w \in K \cap \Sigma^+$, and $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$ if $\varepsilon \in K$;

(Const) $[\vec{x}] \to \vec{x}$ for every $\vec{x} \in \mathrm{Obs}(K)$;

(Comp) $[\vec{z}] \to \rho([\vec{u}_1], \ldots, [\vec{u}_r])$ for every composition witness of rank $1 \le r \le r_{\max}$;

(Link) $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$ for $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in \mathrm{Obs}_d(K)$ with $s^{(d)}(\vec{x}) = s^{(d)}(\vec{y})$ and $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}] \in K$ for some $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$.

For $K \neq \emptyset$ put $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K) := \widehat{G}(K) := \widehat{G}_{\le \|K\|_+}(K)$; $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(\emptyset)$ has no rules. Fixed encoding orders make both operators deterministic and set-driven.

By (3.1), $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)$ contains a Comp rule for every composition witness in K. Both operators are sample-consistent, via $\widehat{S} \to [(w)] \to (w)$ and $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$. All non-start templates are ε-free, so $\widehat{S} \Rightarrow^* \varepsilon$ only by the rule $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$. For the trivial typing and $\varepsilon \notin K$, Comp/Const, Link and Start correspond to the rules of Types I–III of [14, Section 4.1], and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ corresponds to the operator of the unbounded-rank learner $\mathcal{A}(p, *)$ of [14, Corollary 2].

3.2 Yield-Typed Refinement and Witnesses

Definition 3.5 (Yield-type refinement)**.** Let $G = (V, \Sigma, P, S, \mathrm{fan})$ be a finite nondeleting MCFG and s a typing. For a template ρ and $\mathbf{t}_j \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{d_j}$, let $\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{t}_r) \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{d_0}$ have ith component the image of α_i under the monoid morphism $\Gamma_\rho^* \to \mathsf{S}^\sharp$ extending $a \mapsto \widehat{s}(a)$ and $\xi_j^\kappa \mapsto (\mathbf{t}_j)_\kappa$. The *full yield-type refinement* $G^{\widehat{s}}$ has a fresh start symbol $\widetilde{S}$, nonterminals $A_{\mathbf{t}}$ for $A \in V$ and $\mathbf{t} \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, start rules $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(m)}$ for $m \in \mathsf{S}^\sharp$, and for every rule $A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_r)$ (including $r = 0$) and all $\mathbf{t}_j \in (\mathsf{S}^\sharp)^{\mathrm{fan}(B_j)}$ the rule $A_{\mathrm{out}_\rho(\mathbf{t}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{t}_r)} \to \rho(B_{1,\mathbf{t}_1}, \ldots, B_{r,\mathbf{t}_r})$. The *trimmed refinement* $\widetilde{G}_0$ keeps exactly the nonterminals and rules occurring in some successful derivation from $\widetilde{S}$. Unless $G^{\widehat{s}}$ is named, *typed nonterminals* and *typed rules* are the non-start nonterminals and rules of $\widetilde{G}_0$, and $L_X := \{\vec{u} : X \Rightarrow^*_{\widetilde{G}_0} \vec{u}\}$.

Typed rules have the templates of their sources, so $\widetilde{G}_0$ is good whenever G is; each L_X is nonempty, and its tuples have nonempty components if G is ε-free.

Proposition 3.6 (Yield-type invariants)**.** *(i) If $A_{\mathbf{t}} \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$ in $G^{\widehat{s}}$, then $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$, and erasing indices gives a G-derivation of $\vec{u}$.*

(ii) Every terminal derivation $A \Rightarrow^*_G \vec{u}$ lifts uniquely to $A_{\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\vec{u})} \Rightarrow^*_{G^{\widehat{s}}} \vec{u}$; a successful derivation of w lifts uniquely through $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(\widehat{s}(w))}$.

(iii) $L(\widetilde{G}_0) = L(G^{\widehat{s}}) = L(G)$.

(iv) For every typed nonterminal X, every terminal derivation $X \Rightarrow^*_{G^{\widehat{s}}} \vec{u}$ uses only rules of $\widetilde{G}_0$; hence $L_X = \{\vec{u} : X \Rightarrow^*_{G^{\widehat{s}}} \vec{u}\}$.

Lemma 3.7 (Canonical contexts for typed nonterminals)**.** *Let G be good. Every typed nonterminal X of arity d has a context $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$ with $\chi(X)[\vec{u}] \in L(G)$ for all $\vec{u} \in L_X$; if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$, one may take $\chi(X) = \Box_1$.*

Lemma 3.8 (Typed nonterminals are distributionally homogeneous)**.** *Let G be good of fan-out $\le f$ with $L := L(G) \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. For every typed nonterminal X of arity d, L_X lies in a single $\equiv^d_{L,s}$-class, denoted $\mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$.*

The semantic class $\mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$ is distinct from the syntactic reconstruction nonterminal $[\vec{x}]$ of Definition 3.4.

The proofs of these three statements are in Appendix E. The homogeneity of Lemma 3.8 is weaker than that of congruential MCFGs [17], whose contexts may have empty separators.

Definition 3.9 (Canonical tuples, contexts and the witness set)**.** Let G be good. For every typed nonterminal X fix a *canonical tuple* $\omega(X) \in L_X$ and a *canonical context* $\chi(X)$ as in Lemma 3.7, with $\chi(X) = \square_1$ whenever $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$. Let $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ consist of the words

$$\chi(X)[\omega(X)] \ \ (X \text{ typed}), \qquad \chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))] \ \ (X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q) \text{ typed}, \ q \geq 0).$$

Since $\omega(X)$ and $\rho(\omega(Y_1), \ldots, \omega(Y_q))$ belong to L_X, $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ is a finite subset of $L(G)$, nonempty if $L(G) \neq \emptyset$, and $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)|$ is at most the number of typed nonterminals and rules. Canonical objects are properties of the target, not inputs of the operator: qualitatively any choice works, while Section 4 chooses short ones.

3.3 Qualitative Guarantees

Proposition 3.10 (Soundness of every hypothesis)**.** *Let L be (f,s)-tuple-substitutable and $K \subseteq L$ finite. For every $r_{\max} \geq 1$, if $[\vec{x}] \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$ in $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$, then $\vec{u} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}$. Consequently $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)) \subseteq L$ and $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)) \subseteq L$.*

Proposition 3.11 (Completeness from a witness assignment)**.** *Let G be a finite good MCFG of fan-out $\leq f$, let r_G be the maximum rank of a typed rule of $\widetilde{G}_0$ ($r_G := 0$ if none), and assign to each typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$ a tuple $\iota(X) \in (\Sigma^+)^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$ with $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\iota(X)) = \mathbf{t}$ and a context $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, with $\chi(X) = \square_1$ if $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is in $\widetilde{G}_0$. Suppose K contains $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ for each X and $\chi(X)[\rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q))]$ for each typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$, $q \geq 0$. Then*

$$L(G) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)) \quad (r_{\max} \geq \max\{1, r_G\}), \qquad L(G) \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)).$$

Neither substitutability nor $\iota(X) \in L_X$ is assumed in Proposition 3.11; $\iota = \omega$ is the case $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \subseteq K$.

Exact reconstruction needs a good presentation of the target; the following normalization controls size, fan-out and rank, but not thickness. The rule thickness of G_{good} may exceed that of G_{in}, so all data bounds below are stated relative to a given reduced good presentation and are not transferred through normalization.

Proposition 3.12 (Good normalization with rank preservation)**.** *Let G_{in} be a finite standard f-MCFG of rule rank at most $r_{\max}$. There is a finite good f-MCFG G_{good} of rule rank at most $r_{\max}$ with $L(G_{\mathrm{good}}) = L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ and, for fixed $f, r_{\max}$, $\|G_{\mathrm{good}}\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\mathrm{in}}\|)$. If $L(G_{\mathrm{in}}) \cap \Sigma^+ \neq \emptyset$, G_{good} is reduced.*

Theorem 3.13 (Exact reconstruction for a fixed typing)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$ and a typing s, and let $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$. If $L \cap \Sigma^+ = \emptyset$ put $\mathcal{F}_L := L$ and $r_G := 0$. Otherwise let G be a reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$ presentation of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ (Proposition 3.12), let r_G be as in Proposition 3.11, and put $\mathcal{F}_L := \mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$. Then $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq L$ is finite, and every finite K with $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq K \subseteq L$ satisfies*

$$L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)) = L, \qquad L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)) = L \quad \text{for every } r_{\max} \geq \max\{1, r_G\}.$$

If $L \in \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r)$, G can be chosen of rank $\leq r$, so $r_{\max} = \max\{1, r\}$ suffices (also when $r = 0$).

Theorem 3.14 (Polynomial construction under a rule-rank cap)**.** *Fix $f, r_{\max} \geq 1$ and s. The encoding of $\widehat{G}_{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$ is computable in time $(1 + \|K\|_+)^{O(f r_{\max})}$; its fan-out is at most f and its rank at most $r_{\max}$.*

Definition 3.15 (Conservative sequential learner)**.** The learner $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}$ (respectively $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$) starts with H_0, keeps its hypothesis on $\perp$ and on every datum the hypothesis generates, and otherwise replaces it by $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}(K)$ (respectively $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}(K)$), where K is the content read so far. This is the policy of [14, Algorithm 1].

Corollary 3.16 (Gold identification)**.** *Fix $f \geq 1$ and s.*

(i) *$\mathcal{A}_{f,s}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$.*

(ii) *For fixed $r_{\max}$, $\mathcal{A}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ TxtEx-identifies $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}} \cap \mathsf{MCFL}(f, r_{\max})$, and processes each datum in time polynomial in $\|K\|_+$ for the content K read so far.*

Proofs are in Appendix D (Proposition 3.12: Appendix F). None of these statements bounds the length of characteristic data or the stage of convergence.

3.4 Typed versus Untyped Classes

Regular path languages give simple members of every class.

Lemma 3.17 (Path languages)**.** *Let R be the set of labels of paths from a vertex p to a vertex p' in a finite directed graph in which every letter labels exactly one edge. If $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ and $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ satisfy $E[\vec{x}], E[\vec{y}] \in R$, then $F[\vec{x}] \in R \iff F[\vec{y}] \in R$ for every $F \in \mathcal{E}_d$.*

Proof. A word of Σ^+ lies in R iff the target of the edge of each letter is the source of the edge of the next one, the first edge starts at p and the last ends at p'. The h-th hole of E is preceded by the last letter of v_{h-1}, or by the vertex p when $h = 1$ and $v_0 = \varepsilon$, and is followed likewise; internal separators are nonempty. So E determines the vertices at both ends of each hole, and x_h and y_h label paths between the same two vertices. Replacing every x_h by y_h in $F[\vec{x}]$ therefore preserves all three conditions, and conversely. □

The class grows strictly with the typing already at fan-out two, and outside the context-free languages; the untyped operator then over-generalizes.

Proposition 3.18 (A typed class beyond the untyped one)**.** *Let $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}, \mathtt{d}, \#_1, \#_2, \#_3\}$, let $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{Z}_2$ count the letters $\mathtt{a}$ and $\mathtt{c}$ modulo 2, and let*

$$L_{\mathrm{sep}} := \{\mathtt{a}^m \#_1 \mathtt{b}^n \#_2 \mathtt{c}^{m'} \#_3 \mathtt{d}^n : m, n \geq 0,\ m' \in \{m, m-1\},\ m' \geq 0\}.$$

(i) *L_{sep} is a 2-MCFL of rule rank two and is not context-free.*

(ii) *L_{sep} is (f, s)-tuple-substitutable for every $f \geq 1$; hence $L_{\mathrm{sep}} \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ for every $f \geq 2$.*

(iii) *L_{sep} is not (f, s_{triv})-tuple-substitutable for any $f \geq 1$: the words $\mathtt{a}$ and $\mathtt{aa}$ share the context $\Box_1 \#_1 \#_2 \mathtt{c} \#_3$ but not the context $\Box_1 \#_1 \#_2 \#_3$. Accordingly, on the sample $K = \{\mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\mathtt{c}\#_3,\ \mathtt{aa}\#_1\#_2\mathtt{c}\#_3,\ \mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\#_3\} \subseteq L_{\mathrm{sep}}$ the untyped operator $\mathcal{B}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$ derives $\mathtt{aa}\#_1\#_2\#_3 \notin L_{\mathrm{sep}}$, whereas $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ does not link $\mathtt{a}$ with $\mathtt{aa}$.*

Proof. Let $\psi : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{Z}^2$ be the morphism with $\psi(\mathtt{a}) = (1,0)$, $\psi(\mathtt{c}) = (-1,0)$, $\psi(\mathtt{b}) = (0,1)$, $\psi(\mathtt{d}) = (0,-1)$ and $\psi(\#_i) = (0,0)$, and let $R := \mathtt{a}^*\#_1\mathtt{b}^*\#_2\mathtt{c}^*\#_3\mathtt{d}^*$. Then $L_{\mathrm{sep}} = R \cap \psi^{-1}(P)$ with $P := \{(0,0),(1,0)\}$, and R is the path language from 0 to 3 of the graph on $\{0,1,2,3\}$ with loops $\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b},\mathtt{c},\mathtt{d}$ at $0,1,2,3$ and edges $\#_h : h-1 \to h$; every letter labels exactly one edge.

(i) The rules $E \to (\varepsilon,\varepsilon) \mid (\mathtt{a}\xi_1^1, \mathtt{c}\xi_1^2)(E)$, $D \to (\varepsilon,\varepsilon) \mid (\mathtt{b}\xi_1^1, \mathtt{d}\xi_1^2)(D)$ and

$$S \to (\xi_1^1\#_1\xi_2^1\#_2\xi_1^2\#_3\xi_2^2)(E,D) \mid (\mathtt{a}\xi_1^1\#_1\xi_2^1\#_2\xi_1^2\#_3\xi_2^2)(E,D)$$

form a standard MCFG of fan-out two and rule rank two generating L_{sep}, since E derives the pairs $(\mathtt{a}^k,\mathtt{c}^k)$ and D the pairs $(\mathtt{b}^n,\mathtt{d}^n)$. The words of L_{sep} in which $\mathtt{a}$ and $\mathtt{c}$ occur an even number of times altogether are exactly those with $m' = m$; this is an intersection with a regular language, and erasing the markers maps the result onto $\{\mathtt{a}^m\mathtt{b}^n\mathtt{c}^m\mathtt{d}^n : m,n \geq 0\}$, which is not context-free. Context-free languages are closed under both operations.

(ii) Let $1 \leq d \leq f$, let $\vec{x},\vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ have equal componentwise s-types, and let $E \in \mathcal{E}_d$ accept both. Put $(\delta_1,\delta_2) := \sum_i(\psi(x_i) - \psi(y_i)) = \psi(E[\vec{x}]) - \psi(E[\vec{y}]) \in P - P$, so $\delta_2 = 0$ and $\delta_1 \in \{-1,0,1\}$. The first coordinate of ψ is congruent to s modulo 2 on every word, so δ_1 is even; hence $\psi(F[\vec{x}]) = \psi(F[\vec{y}])$ for every $F \in \mathcal{E}_d$. By Lemma 3.17, $F[\vec{x}] \in R$ iff $F[\vec{y}] \in R$. So F accepts $\vec{x}$ iff it accepts $\vec{y}$. With (i), $L_{\mathrm{sep}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ for $f \geq 2$.

(iii) The two contexts give $\mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\mathtt{c}\#_3$, $\mathtt{aa}\#_1\#_2\mathtt{c}\#_3 \in L_{\mathrm{sep}}$ ($m' = m$ and $m' = m-1$), $\mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\#_3 \in L_{\mathrm{sep}}$ and $\mathtt{aa}\#_1\#_2\#_3 \notin L_{\mathrm{sep}}$. On K, the first context gives the Link rule $[(\mathtt{a})] \to [(\mathtt{aa})]$ for the trivial typing, and $((\mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\#_3),(\xi_1^1\#_1\#_2\#_3),((\mathtt{a})))$ is a composition witness of rank one, so $\widehat{S} \to [(\mathtt{a}\#_1\#_2\#_3)] \to [(\mathtt{a})]\#_1\#_2\#_3 \to [(\mathtt{aa})]\#_1\#_2\#_3 \to \mathtt{aa}\#_1\#_2\#_3$. Under s the types of $\mathtt{a}$ and $\mathtt{aa}$ differ, so no such Link rule exists. □

The positive image of s is the group $\mathbb{Z}_2$, a local group, so Theorem A gives L_{sep} characteristic data of length $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ for each of its reduced good presentations of rank at most $r_{\max}$, at every fixed fan-out $f \geq 2$ (with the constant depending on f, $r_{\max}$, s and Σ), while L_{sep} lies outside the class of Yoshinaka's untyped learner [14] at every fan-out.

4 Characteristic-Data Bounds

Fix f, $r_{\max}$, Σ and s, and a reduced good MCFG $G = (V,\Sigma,P,S,\mathrm{fan})$ with trimmed $\widehat{s}$-refinement $\widetilde{G}_0$. The reconstruction already has $O(\|G\|)$ characteristic words (Theorem 3.13); we bound their total length in terms of G. Lemma 4.2 converts short same-type substitutes of nonterminal yields into a sample-length bound. Section 5.1 obtains the substitutes by simultaneous shortening and heavy-node counting (Lemma 5.1); local-group typings reduce to sliding-factor coordinates (Section 5.3). The full type-refined grammar may be exponentially thicker than G (Proposition 4.7), so it is not our complexity parameter. Auxiliary proofs are in Appendix E.

4.1 Thickness Scales and Witness Length

For a rule R of G let

$$\theta_G(R) := \min\{\,|w| : w \in L(G) \text{ has a successful derivation using } R\,\},$$

the length of the derived *sentence*, not of the derivation. Put $\theta_G := \max_{R\in P}\theta_G(R)$, $\bar{\theta}_G := \max\{1,\theta_G\}$ and $t_G := \max_{A\in V}\min\{\|\vec{w}\|_1 : \vec{w} \in L_A(G)\}$ (rule and nonterminal thickness; θ_G is the thickness of [14, Section 4.3]).

If a target L contains ε, every statement below is applied to $L \cap \Sigma^+$ and the datum ε is added, as in Theorem 3.13; this adds one to the encoded length.

Lemma 4.1 (Thickness lemma)**.** *Let G be reduced and good.*

(i) *Every rule writes at most θ_G terminal symbols explicitly.*

(ii) *$t_G \le \theta_G$: every $A \in V$ has some $\vec{u} \in L_A(G)$ with $\|\vec{u}\|_1 \le \theta_G$.*

(iii) *$\theta_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$.*

(iv) *Every $A \in V$ of fan-out d has a context $E_A \in \mathcal{E}_d$ with $|E_A|_{\mathrm{fix}} \le \theta_G$ that results from a successful derivation by deleting one occurrence of an A-subtree; $E_S = \square_1$, and $E_A[\vec{u}] \in L(G)$ for all $\vec{u} \in L_A(G)$. For every typed nonterminal $X = A_{\mathbf{t}}$, the choice $\chi(X) := E_A$ meets Definition 3.9 and is* derivational *for X: it results from a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$ by deleting an occurrence of an X-subtree.*

Thus θ_G and t_G are polynomially equivalent on reduced good presentations; Yoshinaka's efficiency criterion measures data in target size and rule thickness [14, Definition 1]; see also [10].

For a finite-monoid morphism $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ we write $s \preceq \lambda$ if $\ker(\lambda|_{\Sigma^+}) \subseteq \ker s$; since $\widehat{s}$ separates ε, this is the relation of Definition 2.3 whenever λ also separates ε from Σ^+. For $\beta \ge 0$ consider

($\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta}$) for every $B \in V$ and $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ there is $\vec{u}' \in L_B(G)$ with $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u})$ and $\|\vec{u}'\|_1 \le \beta$.

Put

$$C_s(G) := |V||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^f + |P||\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}} \;\le\; |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\, \|G\|,$$

using $|V| + |P| \le \|G\|$; it bounds the numbers of typed nonterminals and typed rules together, since a typed rule is determined by its source rule and the type vectors of its at most $r_{\max}$ children.

Lemma 4.2 (Witness length)**.** *Let $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ be a finite-monoid morphism with $s \preceq \lambda$.*

(i) (Type-preserving exchange.) *If $X = B_{\mathbf{t}}$ is a typed nonterminal, $\vec{u} \in L_X$, $\vec{u}' \in L_B(G)$ and $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u})$, then $\vec{u}' \in L_X$. Hence under ($\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta}$) there are canonical tuples with $\|\omega(X)\|_1 \le \beta$ for every X.*

(ii) (Length.) *Let $\chi(X) := E_B$ for $X = B_{\mathbf{t}}$, as in Lemma 4.1(iv), and let ι assign to every typed X a tuple $\iota(X)$ of nonempty words of its arity with $\|\iota(X)\|_1 \le b$. Let W_ι consist of the words $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ and $\chi(X)[\rho(\iota(Y_1), \dots, \iota(Y_q))]$ for typed rules $X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$, $q \ge 0$; thus $\mathsf{W}_\omega = \mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$. Every word of W_ι has length at most $2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b$, and*

$$|\mathsf{W}_\iota| \le C_s(G), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}_\iota\|_+ \le C_s(G)\,\big(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b\big).$$

(iii) (Refined thickness.) *In (ii), each rule word $\chi(X)[\rho(\omega(Y_1), \dots, \omega(Y_q))]$ is the yield of a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$ using the typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \dots, Y_q)$; hence $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_0} \le 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b$.*

(iv) (Characteristic sample.) *Let $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$ for some $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, and in* (ii) *let $\iota(X) \in \mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$ for every X (Lemma 3.8), for instance $\iota = \omega$. Then $\mathsf{W}_\iota \subseteq L$, and $\mathsf{W}_\iota \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ and for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$.*

Items (i)–(iii) of Lemma 4.2 do not use substitutability.

4.2 Typed Thickness and Characteristic Data

Recall that $\widetilde{G}_0$ is the trimmed full yield-type refinement of G (Definition 3.5). Define

$$t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) := \max_{X} \min_{\vec{u}\in L_X} \|\vec{u}\|_1,$$

where X ranges over the non-start typed nonterminals, and let $N_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s)$ denote their number plus the number of non-start typed rules. In particular $N_{\mathrm{typ}} \le C_s(G) \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\|G\|$.

Theorem 4.3 (Characteristic data from typed thickness)**.** *Let $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ and G be a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r_{\max}$ grammar with $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$. Take shortest canonical tuples and the derivational contexts E_B of Lemma 4.1(iv). Then $K = \mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ is a characteristic sample for both $\mathcal{B}^{\le r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$, with*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \le N_{\mathrm{typ}}, \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le N_{\mathrm{typ}}\bigl(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} t_{\mathrm{typ}}\bigr).$$

For the full sample K, the length bound has the additional term $\mathbf{1}_{\{\varepsilon\in L\}}$.

The numerical length estimate holds for any typing; substitutability is used only for the characteristic-sample claim.

For the trivial typing, every nonterminal of the ε-free G has one realized type vector, so $t_{\mathrm{typ}} = t_G$ and $N_{\mathrm{typ}} = |V| + |P| \le \|G\|$. The theorem recovers the $O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ untyped scale, although Yoshinaka's original sample has the sharper bounds $|K_G| \le |P|$ and $\|K_G\| \le |P|\theta_G$ [14, Lemma 7 and Theorem 1]. A nontrivial typing may instead make t_{typ} exponential.

Presentation-independent lower bounds from rare types. For $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ and $m \in \mathsf{S}$ put

$$\mu_m(L) := \min\{|w| : w \in L \cap \Sigma^+,\ s(w) = m\}, \qquad (\min \emptyset := \infty).$$

For a nonempty set of realized types $\mathsf{S}_L := s(L \cap \Sigma^+)$, put $\mu^\star(L,s) := \max_{m\in\mathsf{S}_L} \mu_m(L)$; set $\mu^\star(L,s) = 0$ when $\mathsf{S}_L = \emptyset$. A typed start nonterminal $S_{(m)}$ exists for each $m \in \mathsf{S}_L$, and $L_{S_{(m)}} = \{(w) : w \in L \cap \Sigma^+,\ s(w) = m\}$ (Proposition 3.6). Thus, whenever $L \cap \Sigma^+ \ne \emptyset$,

$$\mu^\star(L,s) \le t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) \qquad \text{for every reduced good presentation } G. \tag{4.1}$$

Lemma 4.4 (Deleting an entire yield type)**.** *If $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ and $m \in \mathsf{S}$, then $L^{\setminus m} := L \setminus s^{-1}(m)$ also belongs to $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. Moreover, $L \setminus \{\varepsilon\} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$.*

Proof. Apply Proposition 2.9(iii) with the trivial group and $\mathsf{Acc} = \mathsf{S}^\sharp \setminus \{m\}$, respectively $\mathsf{Acc} = \mathsf{S}$. □

All lower bounds of this paper rest on one principle.

Lemma 4.5 (Distinguishing sub-targets)**.** *Let $L, L' \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ with $L' \subsetneq L$. Every characteristic sample of L for $\mathcal{B}^{\le r}_{f,s}$ ($r \ge 1$) or $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$, and every characteristic sample of L for a set-driven operator having one for L' as well, contains a word of $L \setminus L'$.*

Proof. Let $F \subseteq L'$ be finite. For the canonical operators, Proposition 3.10 applied to the target L' gives $L(\mathcal{B}(F)) \subseteq L' \ne L$, so F is not characteristic for L. For the other operator, let F' be characteristic for L'; then $F \cup F' \subseteq L' \subseteq L$, so if F were characteristic for L, the output on $F \cup F'$ would be both L and L'. □

Proposition 4.6 (Rare types force positive data)**.** *Let $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, and let $m \in \mathsf{S}_L$. Every characteristic sample of L for $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r}_{f,s}$ ($r \geq 1$) or for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ contains a word of type m. The same is true for any set-driven operator having characteristic samples for both L and $L^{\setminus m}$, in particular for an operator having characteristic samples for the entire class $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$. If $\varepsilon \in L$, its sample for either canonical operator must also contain ε; the same holds for a set-driven operator admitting a characteristic sample for $L \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ as well. Consequently, for the canonical operators and for class-wide set-driven operators, every characteristic sample F satisfies*

$$\|F\|_+ \geq \sum_{m \in \mathsf{S}_L} \big(\mu_m(L) + 1\big) + \mathbf{1}_{\{\varepsilon \in L\}}.$$

Proposition 4.7 (Exponential blow-up of full yield-type refinement)**.** *Let $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{c}\}$ and let $s_{\mathtt{c}}$ be the typing onto $U_1 = \{1, \zeta\}$ ($\zeta^2 = \zeta$, Section 7) with $s_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{a}) = 1$ and $s_{\mathtt{c}}(\mathtt{c}) = \zeta$. For $n \geq 1$ the fan-out-one, rank-two grammar*

$$S \to SS \mid \mathtt{a} \mid \mathtt{c} \mid A_0 \mid \cdots \mid A_n, \qquad A_0 \to \mathtt{a}, \qquad A_i \to A_{i-1}A_{i-1} \mid \mathtt{c} \quad (1 \leq i \leq n)$$

is reduced and good, generates Σ^+, and has $\|G_n\| = O(n)$ and $\theta_{G_n} \leq 2$, but $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G_n, s_{\mathtt{c}}) \geq 2^n$ and $\theta_{\widetilde{G}_{n,0}} \geq 2^n$.

This blow-up concerns the witness construction, not the data, because the tuples used for a typed nonterminal need not be its yields. For a typed nonterminal X, Lemma 3.8 places L_X in one class $\mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$; the *representative length* is

$$\tau_X := \min\{\|\vec{v}\|_1 : \vec{v} \in \mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)\}, \qquad \tau(G, s) := \max_X \tau_X \quad (\max \emptyset := 0).$$

Corollary 4.8 (Characteristic data from equivalent representatives)**.** *Under the hypotheses of Theorem 4.3,*

$$\mu^\star(L, s) \leq \tau(G, s) \leq t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G, s),$$

and L has a characteristic sample K for both $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ with

$$\|K\|_+ \leq N_{\mathrm{typ}}\big(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max}\tau(G, s)\big) + \mathbf{1}_{\{\varepsilon \in L\}}.$$

In Proposition 4.7, $L = \Sigma^+$ and every admissible context accepts every tuple, so two tuples are equivalent exactly when their types agree; single letters represent both types, and $\tau(G_n, s_{\mathtt{c}}) = 1$ although $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G_n, s_{\mathtt{c}}) \geq 2^n$. Corollary 4.8 then gives characteristic data of length $O(\|G_n\|)$. The corollary does not bound τ itself; the proofs below bound t_{typ} and therefore work on G.

5 Upper Bound: Local Groups at Every Fan-Out

This section proves Theorem A; unlike fan-out one, a subtree may contribute separated, differently interleaved components, so shortening must preserve noncommutative product order.

5.1 Short Representatives by Minimal Counterexamples

Let $\lambda : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ be a finite-monoid morphism. A vector $\mathbf{t} \in \mathsf{N}^d$ is *realizable at B* (of fan-out d) if $\mathbf{t} = \lambda^{(d)}(\vec{u})$ for some $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$. A *λ-minimal* derivation for $(B, \mathbf{t})$ is a terminal derivation from B with root λ-vector $\mathbf{t}$ that minimizes first the total yield length and then the number of nodes. For a threshold b, a node is *heavy* if its yield has total length greater than b.

Let $n_\lambda(G)$ be the number of pairs $(C, \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(C))}(\vec{u}))$ with $C \in V$ and $\vec{u} \in L_C(G)$, the *realized labels*; thus $n_\lambda(G) \leq |V||\mathsf{N}|^f$.

Lemma 5.1 (Heavy-node count and shortening principle). (i) *Let $b \geq \bar{\theta}_G$ and $c \geq 0$, and let T be λ-minimal for $(B, \mathbf{t})$. If every antichain of heavy nodes of T has at most c elements, then*

$$\|\textit{root tuple of } T\|_1 \leq (r_{\max} + 1)\, b \max\{1, c\, n_\lambda(G)\}.$$

(ii) (Shortening principle.) *Let $c, c' \geq 0$ and $b = \bar{\theta}_G$. Suppose that for every λ-minimal T and every antichain Q of heavy nodes of T there is $Q_0 \subseteq Q$ with $|Q \setminus Q_0| \leq c'$ such that, if $|Q_0| > c$, the subtrees at the nodes of some nonempty $J \subseteq Q_0$ can be replaced simultaneously by derivations, from the same nonterminals, of tuples of total length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ without changing the root λ-vector. Then every heavy antichain of a λ-minimal derivation has at most $c + c'$ elements, and $(\mathrm{R}^\lambda_\beta)$ holds with $\beta = (r_{\max} + 1)\, \bar{\theta}_G \max\{1, (c + c')\, n_\lambda(G)\}$.*

Proof. (i) Label each node by its nonterminal and the λ-vector of its yield; only realized labels occur. If an ancestor and a proper descendant had the same label, replacing the ancestor's subtree by the descendant's would keep the root λ-vector (templates evaluate λ homomorphically), would not lengthen the root yield (by linearity the descendant's yield is part of the ancestor's), and would remove nodes, contradicting minimality. So every root-to-leaf path has at most $n_\lambda(G)$ nodes. If the root is light its yield has length at most b. Otherwise the heavy nodes form an ancestor-closed subtree whose leaves form an antichain, so there are at most $c\, n_\lambda(G)$ heavy nodes. Every terminal of the root yield is written by a heavy node (at most $\bar{\theta}_G \leq b$ each, Lemma 4.1(i)) or lies in a light child of a heavy node (at most $r_{\max}$ children of length at most b).

(ii) If $|Q_0| > c$, the replacement gives a derivation from B (the nodes of J are incomparable) with root λ-vector $\mathbf{t}$ and a strictly shorter root yield, since every replaced yield had total length greater than $\bar{\theta}_G$ and, by linearity and nondeletion, occurs exactly once in the root yield. This contradicts minimality, so $|Q| \leq c + c'$. For $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ apply (i) to a λ-minimal derivation for $(B, \lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}))$. □

Group constants. For a finite abelian group $\mathbb{H}$, $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{H})$ is the maximal length of a zero-sum-free sequence over $\mathbb{H}$ (one with no nonempty subsequence summing to the identity; thus $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{H}) + 1$ is the Davenport constant; $\mathsf{d}(\{1\}) = 0$). For a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ and $f \geq 1$ put

$$N_{\mathbb{G},f} = \max\{3, |\mathbb{G}|^f\}, \quad \mathcal{P}_f = f^{f+1} f!, \quad M_{\mathbb{G},f} = \mathcal{P}_f\, N_{\mathbb{G},f}^{2^{f^2}},$$

$$c_{\mathbb{G},f} := \begin{cases} \mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f), & \mathbb{G} \text{ abelian}, \\ |\mathbb{G}| - 1, & \mathbb{G} \text{ nonabelian},\ f = 1, \\ M_{\mathbb{G},f} - 1, & \text{otherwise}. \end{cases}$$

$\mathcal{P}_f$ bounds the number of block patterns of one owner, and $N_{\mathbb{G},f} \geq 3$ is needed by the order classification in Appendix A.1. The double exponent 2^{f^2} comes from applying the Erdős–Szekeres-type extraction of Lemma A.8 once for each of up to f^2 ordered pairs of block positions; we do not know whether it is necessary. For abelian groups no order information is needed, and $c_{\mathbb{G},f} = \mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)$ is linear in f (Remark A.3). At fan-out one every owner has a single block on a single row, no homogenization is needed, and the prefix-product pigeonhole alone gives $|\mathbb{G}| - 1$ (Lemma A.2(c)); since $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}) \leq |\mathbb{G}| - 1$, the abelian value is never larger.

Simultaneous block replacement. A *block-replacement family* of width f over $\mathbb{G}$ (Definition A.1) consists of $d \leq f$ rows, each an ordered product in $\mathbb{G}$ of fixed constants and *blocks*; each block has an *owner* in $[m] := \{1, \ldots, m\}$, an original value and a replacement value, and each owner owns at most f blocks, which may interleave with other owners' blocks arbitrarily. $\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J)$ is the value of row ϱ when exactly the blocks of owners in $J \subseteq [m]$ take their replacement values.

Proposition 5.2 (Simultaneous block replacement)**.** *In a block-replacement family of width f over a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ with $m > c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ owners there is a nonempty $J \subseteq [m]$ with $\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J) = \mathrm{val}_\varrho(\varnothing)$ for every row ϱ.*

Proof. This is Lemma A.2. For abelian $\mathbb{G}$ one selects a nonempty zero-sum subsequence of the owners' difference vectors in $\mathbb{G}^d \le \mathbb{G}^f$. At $f = 1$ a pigeonhole on prefix-product states of the single row selects an interval of owners. For arbitrary $\mathbb{G}$ and f no factors are commuted: among owners with a common block pattern (at most $\mathcal{P}_f$ patterns) one homogenizes all pairwise order comparisons (Lemma A.8), which decomposes every row into consecutive rank chunks (Lemma A.4); a pigeonhole on prefix-product boundary states then yields an interval of owners preserving all ordered row products (Lemma A.5). □

Individual block or owner values need not be preserved by the replacement, and owner contributions cannot be commuted: if the two rows are $\mathfrak{b}_{1,1}\mathfrak{b}_{2,1}$ and $\mathfrak{b}_{2,2}\mathfrak{b}_{1,2}$, with value (12) on the blocks of owner 1 and (23) on those of owner 2 in S_3, the row values are $(12)(23) \neq (23)(12)$. Example A.6 shows a replacement preserving rows of opposite owner orientation.

Lemma 5.3 (Short representatives for window–group invariants)**.** *Fix $k, \ell \ge 0$, a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ (possibly trivial) and a morphism $g : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{G}$. Put $\lambda := (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g) : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N} := M_{k,\ell} \times \mathbb{G}$. Then $(\mathrm{R}^\lambda_\beta)$ holds with*

$$\beta = b_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}} := (r_{\max}+1)\,\bar{\theta}_G\,(c_{\mathbb{G},f} + f(k+\ell+1))\,|V||\mathsf{N}|^f \;\le\; (r_{\max}+1)(c_{\mathbb{G},f} + f(k+\ell+1))|\mathsf{N}|^f\,\|G\|\,\bar{\theta}_G.$$

Proof. We verify the hypothesis of Lemma 5.1(ii) with $c = c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ and $c' = f(k+\ell+1)$; since $c + c' \ge 1$ and $n_\lambda(G) \le |V||\mathsf{N}|^f$, it gives the bound, and the second inequality uses $|V| \le \|G\|$. Let T be λ-minimal with heavy threshold $b = \bar{\theta}_G$. In each root component of length at least $m_0 = \max\{1, k+\ell\}$ mark the first k and the last ℓ positions (one arbitrary position if $k = \ell = 0$), and in each shorter component mark all positions: at most c' marks. Let Q be an antichain of heavy nodes. Incomparable subtrees have disjoint yields, so at most c' nodes of Q contain a mark; let Q_0 be the others.

Let $|Q_0| > c_{\mathbb{G},f}$. For $v \in Q_0$ with nonterminal C_v fix a tuple of $L_{C_v}(G)$ of total length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ (Lemma 4.1(ii)). By linearity and nondeletion each $v \in Q_0$ contributes at most f disjoint contiguous blocks to the root components, and the g-value of each root component is the ordered product of the g-values of fixed material and of these blocks. This is a block-replacement family over $\mathbb{G}$ with owners Q_0, so Proposition 5.2 gives a nonempty $J \subseteq Q_0$ whose simultaneous replacement preserves every root g-value. The replaced blocks contain no mark: short root components are untouched, and in a long component they lie strictly between the marked prefix and suffix, which keep their letters and positions relative to the ends, while the component keeps its $k + \ell$ marked letters (at least one if $k = \ell = 0$) and stays long. So the root $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$-vector is preserved as well, and with it the root λ-vector. □

5.2 Window and Window–Group Typings: Explicit Constants

Window–group typings are local-group typings (Proposition B.6(i)), so Theorem A covers them; this subsection is the base case of the replacement argument, with explicit constants. A typing s is a *window–group typing* if $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$ for some $k, \ell \ge 0$, a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ and a morphism $g : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{G}$; for trivial $\mathbb{G}$ this means that s is a window typing.

Proposition 5.4 (Polynomial characteristic data for window–group typings)**.** *Let $\mathbb{G}$ be a finite group (possibly trivial), $g : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{G}$ a morphism, and $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$; let $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ and $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$. Then*

$\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\cup(\{\varepsilon\}\cap L)$ *is a characteristic sample for both* $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}$ *and* $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ *with* $|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| \le C_s(G) = O(\|G\|)$ *and*

$$\|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ \le K_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}}\,\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G,$$
$$K_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}} := |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\big(3 + r_{\max}(r_{\max}+1)(c_{\mathbb{G},f} + f(k+\ell+1))(|M_{k,\ell}||\mathbb{G}|)^f\big).$$

Proof. Lemma 5.3 and Lemma 4.2(i),(ii),(iv) with $\lambda = (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$ and $b = b_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}}$ give the sample and $\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \le C_s(G)(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max} b_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}})$; insert $C_s(G) \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\|G\|$, $1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G \le 3\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G$ and $|V| \le \|G\|$. □

The group may be noncommutative and its blocks may interleave across components. For trivial $\mathbb{G}$, i.e. $s \preceq s_{k,\ell}$, one has $c_{\mathbb{G},f} = 0$.

Remark 5.5 (Abelian groups). If $\mathbb{G}$ is abelian, Lemma A.2(a) gives $c_{\mathbb{G},f} = \mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)$, and $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f) = O(\exp(\mathbb{G})\, f \log|\mathbb{G}|)$ (Remark A.3; $\exp(\mathbb{G})$ is the least common multiple of the element orders), so $K_{k,\ell,\mathbb{G}}$ is polynomial in f apart from the factors $|\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}$ and $(|M_{k,\ell}||\mathbb{G}|)^f$. For nonabelian $\mathbb{G}$ and $f \ge 2$, by contrast, $c_{\mathbb{G},f} = M_{\mathbb{G},f} - 1$ grows doubly exponentially in f.

At fan-out one, polynomial time and thick-data learning for fixed windows is due to Yoshinaka [12, Theorem 1]; the bounds above are relative to a reduced good presentation and are not claimed to improve on that result after normalization. What is new is that window and ordered group values are preserved *simultaneously* across up to f interleaved components.

5.3 Local-Group Typings

LI is the pseudovariety of finite semigroups T satisfying $e\mathsf{T}e = \{e\}$ for every idempotent $e \in \mathsf{T}$, **Grp** that of finite groups, and $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ consists of the divisors of products $\mathsf{T} \times \mathbb{G}$ with $\mathsf{T} \in \mathbf{LI}$ and $\mathbb{G}$ a finite group [26, 27]. By Lemma B.5 (Appendix B), every typing with $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ is a window–group typing, with k, $\mathbb{G}$ and g depending only on s, so Proposition 5.4 applies to it.

A finite semigroup is a *local group*, $\mathsf{T} \in \mathbf{LG}$, if $e\mathsf{T}e$ is a group for every idempotent $e \in \mathsf{T}$. A typing is a *local-group typing* if its positive image S is a local group; the condition is never tested on $\mathsf{S}^\sharp$. By Proposition B.6, $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp} \subsetneq \mathbf{LG}$.

Definition 5.6 (Sliding-factor morphism)**.** Fix $k \ge 1$, a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ and a map $\nu : \Sigma^{k+1} \to \mathbb{G}$ (the *sliding-factor labelling*). For $|w| \ge 2k$ let $\mathrm{fac}_k(w) = (F_1, \dots, F_{|w|-k})$ be the factors of length $k+1$ of w in order of their starting positions, and put $\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) := \nu(F_1)\nu(F_2)\cdots\nu(F_{|w|-k})$ (ordered product in $\mathbb{G}$); put $\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) := 1_{\mathbb{G}}$ for $|w| < 2k$. The *sliding-factor morphism* is $\lambda_{k,\nu}(w) := \big(\widehat{s}_{k,k}(w), \gamma_{k,\nu}(w)\big)$; by Lemma B.1 it is a morphism onto a finite monoid $M_{k,\nu}$. The typing s is *local-group-determined* if $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{k,\nu}$ for some k, $\mathbb{G}$ and ν.

A sliding-factor morphism can encode a group contribution determined by a sliding factor, rather than by each letter alone. For example, $\lambda_{1,\nu}$ with $\nu(\mathtt{ab}) = 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ and zero on other pairs records the parity of occurrences of $\mathtt{ab}$. Even on $\{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b}\}$ this is not determined by any fixed window combined with a finite-group morphism (Proposition B.6(ii)). The local-group characterization below expresses this additional power without requiring a new learner or a target-specific typing.

Theorem 5.7 (Polynomial characteristic data for local-group typings)**.** *Let* $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$*. Every reduced good fan-out-*$\le f$*, rank-*$\le r_{\max}$ *grammar* G *satisfies* $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G,s) = O_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$*. If moreover* $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ *and* $L(G) = L \cap \Sigma^+$*, then* $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0) \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$ *is a characteristic sample for both* $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}$ *and* $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ *with*

$$|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)| = O(\|G\|), \qquad \|\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)\|_+ = O_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G).$$

Proof. By Theorem B.4, $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda := \lambda_{k,\nu}$ for $k = |\mathsf{S}|$ and some $\mathbb{G}, \nu$ depending only on s. Lemma B.8 gives $(\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta})$ with $\beta = \beta_\lambda = O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$: heavy subtrees are replaced by arbitrary short yields of their nonterminals, after the owners have been thinned so that their blocks lie at least $2k$ letters apart and each block has been enlarged by k unchanged letters on both sides (Lemma B.7); the enlarged blocks keep their window types, so the ordered sliding-factor products are controlled by Lemma B.2 and Proposition 5.2. This step uses no substitutability. Lemma 4.2(i) gives $t_{\mathrm{typ}} \le \beta_\lambda$, and Theorem 4.3 gives $\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \le N_{\mathrm{typ}}(1 + 2\bar{\theta}_G + r_{\max}\beta_\lambda) = O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$. □

Dependence of the implicit constant. Writing $C^{\mathrm{buf}} = C^{\mathrm{buf}}_{k,\mathbb{G},f}$ and $M = M_{k,\nu}$ for the fixed auxiliary invariants of Appendix B, the above argument in fact gives

$$\|\mathsf{W}\|_+ \le |\mathsf{S}^\sharp|^{f r_{\max}}\big[3 + r_{\max}(r_{\max}+1)C^{\mathrm{buf}}|M|^f\big]\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G.$$

These are explicit but potentially very large constants of this proof, depending on the fixed alphabet, typing, fan-out and rank; the estimate is *not* a lower bound on the best possible constant.

The Rees and sliding-factor coordinates are classical; their combination with owner-wise block shortening is the quantitative step. Local-group and window–group typings thus have the same quadratic dependence on $\|G\|$; Proposition 5.4 gives explicit constants for the latter.

5.4 Separating Typing Regimes on Non-Context-Free Targets

Theorem A has two ingredients beyond windows: sliding-factor information (local groups rather than window–group typings) and ordered, possibly noncommutative, group products across interleaved components. Proposition B.6 separates the corresponding semigroups. The following targets separate them on languages: each is a non-context-free language of fan-out two that lies in the class of one typing and in the class of no typing of the weaker kind (no window–group typing, respectively no window–abelian typing), so the weaker theorem does not cover it under any typing of that kind. Both have the form $\varsigma w\$x_\times$: a flag $\varsigma = \mathtt{r}$ leaves w unconstrained, $\varsigma = \mathtt{l}$ imposes a typing-dependent condition on w, and $x_\times \in C_\times := \{\mathtt{1}^m\mathtt{2}^n\mathtt{3}^m\mathtt{4}^n : m, n \ge 1\}$ makes the target non-context-free. Let $\varphi_\times$ map $\mathtt{1},\mathtt{3},\mathtt{2},\mathtt{4}$ to $(1,0),(-1,0),(0,1),(0,-1) \in \mathbb{Z}^2$ and all other letters to 0, and let $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$ be the number of occurrences of the factor $\mathtt{ab}$ in w.

Lemma 5.8 (Flag separation)**.** *Let s' be a typing, $u, v \in \Sigma^+$ with $s'(u) = s'(v)$, and $z \in \Sigma^*$. If L contains $\mathtt{r}uz$, $\mathtt{r}vz$ and $\mathtt{l}uz$ but not $\mathtt{l}vz$, then $L \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s'}$ for every $f \ge 1$.*

Proof. $\mathtt{r}\Box_1 z \in \mathcal{E}_1$ accepts u and v, while $\mathtt{l}\Box_1 z$ accepts u but not v; so $\mathcal{D}^{(1)}_L(u) \ne \mathcal{D}^{(1)}_L(v)$, and every (f, s') condition includes arity one. □

The targets. Let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}} = \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r},\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b},\mathtt{c},\$,\mathtt{1},\mathtt{2},\mathtt{3},\mathtt{4}\}$,

$$L_{\mathrm{A}} := \{\varsigma w\$x_\times : \varsigma \in \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\},\ w \in \{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b},\mathtt{c}\}^+,\ x_\times \in C_\times,\ \varsigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } \#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w) \text{ even}\},$$

and $s_{\mathrm{A}} := \lambda_{1,\nu}|_{\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^+}$, corestricted to its positive image, with $\nu : \Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^2 \to \mathbb{Z}_2$, $\nu(\mathtt{ab}) = 1$ and $\nu = 0$ otherwise (Definition 5.6); it records the first and last letters and, for $|w| \ge 2$, the parity of $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$. Let $\Sigma_{\mathrm{B}} = \Sigma_{\mathrm{A}} \setminus \{\mathtt{c}\}$, $\alpha = (12)$, $\beta = (23) \in S_3$, $g_{\mathrm{B}} : \Sigma_{\mathrm{B}}^* \to S_3$ with $\mathtt{a} \mapsto \alpha$, $\mathtt{b} \mapsto \beta$ and all other letters $\mapsto 1$,

$$L_{\mathrm{B}} := \{\varsigma w\$x_\times : \varsigma \in \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\},\ w \in \{\mathtt{a},\mathtt{b}\}^+,\ x_\times \in C_\times,\ \varsigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } g_{\mathrm{B}}(w) = 1\},$$

and $s_{\mathrm{B}} := (\widehat{s}_{1,1}, g_{\mathrm{B}})|_{\Sigma_{\mathrm{B}}^+}$, corestricted. **Ab** is the pseudovariety of finite abelian groups, and $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Ab}$ consists of the divisors of $\mathsf{T} \times \mathbb{G}$ with $\mathsf{T} \in \mathbf{LI}$ and $\mathbb{G}$ finite abelian.

Proposition 5.9 (A target that needs a local group)**.** (i) $L_{\mathrm{A}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2)$ *and* L_{A} *is not context-free.*

(ii) $L_{\mathrm{A}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{A}}}$ *for every* $f \geq 2$*, and* $s_{\mathrm{A}}(\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^{+}) \in \mathbf{LG}$*.*

(iii) *If* $\widehat{s'} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g')$ *for some* k, ℓ *and a morphism* g' *into a finite group (in particular if* $s'(\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^{+}) \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$*), then* $L_{\mathrm{A}} \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s'}$ *for all* $f \geq 1$*.*

Hence $s_{\mathrm{A}}(\Sigma_{\mathrm{A}}^{+}) \in \mathbf{LG} \setminus (\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp})$*, and* L_{A} *is covered by Theorem 5.7 but, for no typing, by Proposition 5.4, even with Lemma B.5.*

Proposition 5.10 (A target that needs a noncommutative group)**.** (i) $L_{\mathrm{B}} \in \mathsf{MCFL}(2,2)$ *and* L_{B} *is not context-free.*

(ii) $L_{\mathrm{B}} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{B}}}$ *for every* $f \geq 2$*, and* s_{B} *is a window–group typing with group* S_3*.*

(iii) *If* $\widehat{s'} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g')$ *for some* k, ℓ *and a morphism* g' *into a finite* abelian *group (in particular if* $s'(\Sigma_{\mathrm{B}}^{+}) \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Ab}$*), then* $L_{\mathrm{B}} \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s'}$ *for all* $f \geq 1$*.*

Hence L_{B} *is covered by Proposition 5.4 with the nonabelian constant* $c_{S_3,f} = M_{S_3,f} - 1$*, but for no typing by its trivial-group or abelian-group cases (Remark 5.5).*

The proofs, with the explicit separating words, are in Appendix C. Both propositions concern class membership, not data length: they show that the typing regimes of Theorem A differ on non-context-free targets, not that its exponent is sharp. Each target is a regular flagged prefix followed by the fixed non-context-free part $C_{\times}$; the separation comes from the prefix. The multiple context-free content of Theorem A lies in the block-replacement argument for arbitrary presentations.

6 Lower Bound: The Linear Factor at Every Fan-Out

This section proves Theorem B.

The upper bound of Theorem 4.3 grows with $\|G\|$, and the rare-type lower bound of Proposition 4.6 does not. Nevertheless the product $\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G$ is necessary at every fan-out, under every typing over an alphabet of at least $4f+1$ letters (two at fan-out one) and for presentations within a constant factor of the smallest.

Proposition 6.1 (The linear factor is necessary at every fan-out)**.** *Let* $f \geq 1$*, let* Σ *contain* $4f+1$ *distinct letters* $\mathtt{a}_1, \ldots, \mathtt{a}_{2f}, \mathtt{d}_1, \ldots, \mathtt{d}_{2f}, \mathtt{z}$*, and let* s *be any typing. For integers* $q \geq n \geq 1$ *put* $W := 2fq + 2^n + 2f$ *and*

$$w_i := \mathtt{a}_1^i \mathtt{d}_1 \mathtt{a}_2^i \mathtt{d}_2 \cdots \mathtt{a}_{2f}^i \mathtt{d}_{2f} \mathtt{z}^{2f(q-i)+2^n} \quad (0 \leq i \leq q), \qquad L^{(f)}_{q,n} := \{w_0, \ldots, w_q\}.$$

(i) *Every subset of* $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *belongs to* $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}} \subseteq \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$*.*

(ii) *For* $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$*, for* $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r}_{f,s}$ $(r \geq 1)$*, and for every set-driven operator with characteristic samples throughout* $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$*, the only characteristic sample of* $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *is* $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *itself.*

(iii) $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *has a reduced good presentation* $G^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *of fan-out* f *and rule rank two with* $\|G^{(f)}_{q,n}\| = (7f+11)q + 6n + 3f + 10 \leq (7f+17)(q+1)$ *and* $\bar{\theta}_{G^{(f)}_{q,n}} = W$*. Every reduced good fan-out-*$\leq f$ *presentation* G *of* $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ *has* $\bar{\theta}_G = W$ *and* $\|G\| \geq q+1$*.*

(iv) *For $f = 1$,* (i)–(iii) *hold over any alphabet containing two letters* $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{d}$*, for the words* $w_i = \mathtt{a}^i\mathtt{d}\mathtt{a}^i\mathtt{d}\mathtt{a}^{2(q-i)+2^n}$ *obtained by identifying* $\mathtt{a}_1, \mathtt{a}_2, \mathtt{z}$ *with* $\mathtt{a}$ *and* $\mathtt{d}_1, \mathtt{d}_2$ *with* $\mathtt{d}$*, and the grammar identified in the same way.*

Consequently every characteristic sample F in (ii) *satisfies*

$$\|F\|_+ = (q+1)(W+1) \;\geq\; \tfrac{1}{7f+17}\,\|G^{(f)}_{q,n}\|\,\bar{\theta}_{G^{(f)}_{q,n}}.$$

Each word w_i is determined by the position of one marker and by the distance of two, which gives (i) (Appendix H). With $q = n$ one has $\|G^{(f)}_{n,n}\| = \Theta(n)$ and $\bar{\theta}_{G^{(f)}_{n,n}} = 2^n + \Theta(n)$; with n fixed, $\bar{\theta}_{G^{(f)}_{q,n}} = \Theta(\|G^{(f)}_{q,n}\|)$. By (iii) the presentations are within a constant factor of the smallest reduced good ones, so the bound is not obtained by padding G; with the trivial typing the proposition shows that Yoshinaka's bound $\|K_G\| \leq |P|\theta_G$ is attained up to a constant factor. All yields of a nonterminal of $G^{(f)}_{q,n}$ have one total length, so $t_{\mathrm{typ}} = \bar{\theta}_G = W$ for this family, and it says nothing about the further factor $\|G\|$ in Proposition 5.4 and Theorem 5.7. The proof is in Appendix H.

Corollary 6.2 (The trivial typing)**.** *Fix f and $r_{\max} \geq 1$. For the trivial typing, every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$ and every reduced good rank-$\leq r_{\max}$ presentation G of $L \cap \Sigma^+$, the operator $\mathcal{B}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$ has a characteristic sample of total length $O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$, as for Yoshinaka's sample [14, Lemma 7 and Theorem 1]. Suppose moreover that $r_{\max} \geq 2$ and that Σ has at least $4f+1$ letters, or that $r_{\max} \geq 2$, $f = 1$ and Σ has at least two letters. Then this bound is attained up to a constant factor: for the targets $L^{(f)}_{q,n}$ and presentations $G^{(f)}_{q,n}$ of Proposition 6.1, every characteristic sample has length at least $\|G^{(f)}_{q,n}\|\bar{\theta}_{G^{(f)}_{q,n}}/(7f+17)$.*

Proof. Every typed nonterminal is an untyped one, so $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G, s_{\mathrm{triv}}) \leq \bar{\theta}_G$ by Lemma 4.1, and Theorem 4.3 gives $O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$. Proposition 6.1 gives the second assertion; the presentations $G^{(f)}_{q,n}$ have rule rank two, which is why $r_{\max} \geq 2$ is needed there. □

A characteristic sample stays characteristic when finitely many words of the target are added, so only the length of a *shortest* characteristic sample is meaningful; the corollary bounds it from above for every target and shows that the bound is attained by one family.

7 The Boundary at Fan-Out One

This section proves Theorem C.

A three-letter doubling family. Let $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}$ be distinct letters, let $U_1 = \{1, \zeta\}$ with identity 1 and $\zeta^2 = \zeta$, and let $s_U : \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}^+ \twoheadrightarrow U_1$ send $\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}$ to 1 and $\mathtt{c}$ to ζ; thus $s_U(w) = 1$ exactly for the nonempty words without $\mathtt{c}$. For $n \geq 1$ let G_n be the fan-out-one grammar

$$S \to E_n, \qquad E_0 \to \mathtt{a}, \qquad E_i \to \mathtt{b}E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\mathtt{b} \mid \mathtt{c}E_{i-1}\mathtt{c} \quad (1 \leq i \leq n),$$

put $L^{(i)} := L_{E_i}(G_n)$, so $L^{(0)} = \{\mathtt{a}\}$ and $L^{(i)} = \mathtt{b}L^{(i-1)}L^{(i-1)}\mathtt{b} \cup \mathtt{c}L^{(i-1)}\mathtt{c}$, put $L_n := L^{(n)} = L(G_n)$, $W_0 := \mathtt{a}$ and $W_i := \mathtt{b}W_{i-1}W_{i-1}\mathtt{b}$. This is a three-letter variant of the bracketed doubling family of the companion CFG manuscript [23, Proposition 6.4], in which the opening and closing brackets are different letters; all its properties are proved here.

Proposition 7.1 (Three-letter doubling family)**.** *For every $n \geq 1$:*

(i) *G_n is reduced and good, of fan-out one and rule rank two, with $\|G_n\| = 13n+7$ and $\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = 4n$.*

(ii) *L_n is Clark–Eyraud substitutable: for all $x, y \in \Sigma^+$, $\mathcal{D}^{(1)}_{L_n}(x) \cap \mathcal{D}^{(1)}_{L_n}(y) \neq \emptyset$ implies $\mathcal{D}^{(1)}_{L_n}(x) = \mathcal{D}^{(1)}_{L_n}(y)$. Hence $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s}$ for every typing s on every alphabet $\Sigma \supseteq \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}$; in particular $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$.*

(iii) *W_n is the only word of L_n without $\mathtt{c}$, hence the only one of s_U-type 1, and $|W_n| = 3 \cdot 2^n - 2$.*

(iv) *Every characteristic sample F of L_n for $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r}_{1,s_U}$ ($r \geq 1$) or $\mathcal{B}_{1,s_U}$, or for any set-driven operator having characteristic samples throughout $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$, contains W_n; hence $\|F\|_+ \geq 3 \cdot 2^n - 1$.*

The proof is in Appendix G: (iii) holds because a derivation without $\mathtt{c}$ is the complete binary tree, and (iv) follows from (iii) and Proposition 4.6.

Definition 7.2 (Uniform polynomial characteristic-data length)**.** Let $f, r_{\max} \geq 1$. A pseudovariety $\mathbf{V}$ of finite semigroups has *uniform polynomial characteristic-data length at fan-out f and rank $r_{\max}$* if for every nonempty finite alphabet Σ and every surjective typing $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ with $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{V}$ there is a polynomial $p = p_{f,r_{\max},s,\Sigma}$ such that for every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ and every reduced good fan-out-$\leq f$, rank-$\leq r_{\max}$ presentation G of $L \cap \Sigma^+$, the operator $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{f,s}$ has a characteristic sample F for L with $\|F\|_+ \leq p(\|G\|, \bar{\theta}_G)$.

The quantifiers are ordered as written: p may depend on f, $r_{\max}$, Σ and the typing s, but not on the target L or the presentation G.

Theorem 7.3 (Fan-out one: a pseudovariety boundary for data length)**.** *Let $r_{\max} \geq 2$ and let $\mathbf{V}$ be a pseudovariety of finite semigroups.*

(i) *$\mathbf{V}$ has uniform polynomial characteristic-data length at fan-out one and rank $r_{\max}$ if and only if $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$.*

(ii) *If $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$, one may take $p(\|G\|, \bar{\theta}_G) = O_{r_{\max},s,\Sigma}(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$ in Definition 7.2.*

(iii) *If $\mathbf{V} \not\subseteq \mathbf{LG}$, the typing s_U of Proposition 7.1 has positive image $U_1 \in \mathbf{V}$, and the targets $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$ have reduced good rank-two presentations G_n with $\|G_n\| = 13n+7$ and $\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = 4n$, while every characteristic sample of L_n has total encoded length at least $3 \cdot 2^n - 1 \geq 2^{(\|G_n\| + \bar{\theta}_{G_n})/17}$. This lower bound holds for $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{1,s_U}$, for $\mathcal{B}_{1,s_U}$, and for every set-driven operator having characteristic samples throughout $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$.*

Proof. (ii), and hence the *if* direction of (i), is Theorem 5.7 with $f = 1$, since every $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{V}$ then lies in $\mathbf{LG}$. For (iii), pick $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{V} \setminus \mathbf{LG}$. By Theorem B.4(ii), S has a subsemigroup isomorphic to U_1, and $U_1 \in \mathbf{V}$ because pseudovarieties are closed under subsemigroups. The typing s_U maps onto U_1; the remaining claims are Proposition 7.1(i) and (iv), using $\|G_n\| = O(n)$ and $\theta_{G_n} \leq 4n$. Since $3 \cdot 2^n - 1$ is not bounded by any polynomial in $\|G_n\|$ and $\bar{\theta}_{G_n}$, the *only if* direction of (i) follows. □

Remark 7.4 (Scope of Theorem 7.3). (a) The lower bound uses rank two: the doubling rules $E_i \to \mathtt{b}E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\mathtt{b}$ are binary. For targets represented by linear CFGs the companion manuscript gives, for every fixed typing, characteristic data polynomial in the grammar size alone [23, Theorem 8.3]. (b) The theorem concerns pseudovarieties; which individual typings have polynomial data is not characterized here. (c) The upper bound is for the fixed operator $\mathcal{B}^{\leq r_{\max}}_{1,s}$, whereas the lower bound holds for every set-driven operator with characteristic samples throughout the class. (d) At fan-out $f \geq 2$ the *if* direction persists (Theorem 5.7), but the *only if* direction is open (Open Problem 9.1); the family L_n cannot serve there (Theorem 8.2).

Polynomial time and thick data. Eyraud, Heinz and Yoshinaka [10, Definition 2.12], following [12], call a class identifiable in polynomial time and thick data (IPTtD) if some algorithm returns, in time polynomial in the size of a given sample, a hypothesis consistent with it, and every representation R of a target has a characteristic sample of size polynomial in the size of R and its thickness. By Lemma 4.1(ii),(iii), their thickness (the longest shortest yield of a nonterminal, t_G) and our rule thickness are polynomially equivalent given $\|G\|$. The sample sizes $\sum_{w\in K}|w|$ and $\|K\|_+$ differ by at most the number of words. Their definition asks the algorithm to return a hypothesis in a fixed class of representations; the raw output of $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}$ may contain the rule $\widehat{S}\to\varepsilon$, so we first remove it.

Lemma 7.5 (Reduced good hypotheses)**.** *Fix f, $r_{\max}\ge 1$ and s, let $K\subseteq\Sigma^*$ be finite with $K\cap\Sigma^+\neq\emptyset$, and let G_K^+ be $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}(K)$ without the rule $\widehat{S}\to\varepsilon$. Then G_K^+ is a reduced good MCFG of fan-out $\le f$ and rank $\le r_{\max}$, $L(G_K^+)=L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}(K))\setminus\{\varepsilon\}$, and G_K^+ is computable from K in time $(1+\|K\|_+)^{O(fr_{\max})}$.*

Proof. Start and Link rules have identity templates, Const rules write tuples of nonempty words, and Comp rules have good templates (Definition 3.3); so every rule of G_K^+ is good, and no nonterminal derives a tuple with an empty component. Hence ε is derived only by the removed rule, which gives the language. Every $[\vec{x}]$ is productive by its Const rule, and $\widehat{S}$ is productive since K has a nonempty word. For reachability let $\vec{x}\in\mathrm{Obs}_d(K)$, say $w=E[\vec{x}]\in K$ with $E=v_0\Box_1v_1\cdots\Box_dv_d\in\mathcal{E}_d$. Then $w\neq\varepsilon$, $(w)\in\mathrm{Obs}_1(K)$ with the context $\Box_1$, and the template $\rho=(v_0\xi_1^1v_1\cdots\xi_1^dv_d)$ is good: it is ε-free, uses each variable once and in order, and is nonmerging since $v_1,\dots,v_{d-1}$ are nonempty. So $((w),\rho,(\vec{x}))$ is a composition witness of rank one, and $\widehat{S}\to[(w)]\to\rho([\vec{x}])$ reaches $[\vec{x}]$. Fan-out, rank and running time are those of Theorem 3.14. □

Corollary 7.6 (Identification in polynomial time and thick data)**.** *Fix $f\ge 1$, $r_{\max}\ge 1$ and a typing s. Let $\mathcal{R}$ consist of the pairs (G,z) of a bit $z\in\{0,1\}$ and either a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r_{\max}$ MCFG G or a fixed grammar $G_\emptyset$ without rules; the pair represents $L(G)\cup\{\varepsilon : z=1\}$. The members of $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}\cap\mathsf{MCFL}(f,r_{\max})$ are represented by $(G,[\varepsilon\in L])$ with G a reduced good fan-out-$\le f$, rank-$\le r_{\max}$ presentation of $L\cap\Sigma^+$, or $G=G_\emptyset$ if $L\cap\Sigma^+=\emptyset$.*

(i) *If $s(\Sigma^+)\in\mathbf{LG}$, the algorithm returning $(G_K^+,[\varepsilon\in K])$ of Lemma 7.5, or $(G_\emptyset,[\varepsilon\in K])$ if $K\cap\Sigma^+=\emptyset$, identifies $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}\cap\mathsf{MCFL}(f,r_{\max})$ in polynomial time and thick data for the class $\mathcal{R}$.*

(ii) *If $f=1$ and $r_{\max}\ge 2$, no algorithm, whatever its running time, satisfies the data condition of IPTtD for $\mathcal{C}_{1,s_U}^{\mathrm{mcf}}\cap\mathsf{MCFL}(1,r_{\max})$ with respect to the class $\mathcal{R}$.*

(iii) *Consequently, for $r_{\max}\ge 2$ and a pseudovariety $\mathbf{V}$, the following are equivalent: $\mathbf{V}\subseteq\mathbf{LG}$; for every typing s with $s(\Sigma^+)\in\mathbf{V}$, the class $\mathcal{C}_{1,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}\cap\mathsf{MCFL}(1,r_{\max})$ is IPTtD for the class $\mathcal{R}$.*

Proof. (i) By Lemma 7.5 the hypothesis lies in $\mathcal{R}$, is computed in time polynomial in $\|K\|_+$, and represents $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}(K))$, which contains K (each $w\in K\cap\Sigma^+$ is derived by its Start and Const rules). Theorem 5.7 gives a sample F of length $O(\|G\|^2\bar{\theta}_G)$ with $L(\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\le r_{\max}}(K))=L$ whenever $F\subseteq K\subseteq L$, so the hypothesis then represents L; and $\bar{\theta}_G\le 2\|G\|\max\{1,t_G\}$. (ii) In [10, Definition 2.12] an algorithm reads a sample, which is a finite set of strings, so it is a set-driven operator. If such an algorithm satisfied the IPTtD data condition, it would have a characteristic sample for every member of the class; every member L with $L\cap\Sigma^+\neq\emptyset$ has a reduced good presentation of rank $\le r_{\max}$ (Proposition 3.12). The targets L_n of Proposition 7.1 belong to the class, and so does $L_n\setminus\{W_n\}$: it lies in $\mathcal{C}_{1,s_U}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ by Lemma 4.4 and is finite. By Proposition 4.6, every characteristic sample of L_n contains W_n, of length $3\cdot 2^n-2$, while $\|G_n\|=O(n)$ and $t_{G_n}\le\theta_{G_n}\le 4n$. (iii) follows from (i) with $f=1$ and from (ii), since a pseudovariety not contained in $\mathbf{LG}$ contains U_1 (Theorem 7.3). □

The hypotheses lie in $\mathcal{R}$ on every sample; on samples that contain no characteristic sample their languages need not belong to the class, as for the learner of [14]. Item (i) holds at every fan-out, item (ii) only at fan-out one (Theorem 8.2).

Table 2 collects, for each main claim, the fixed parameters, the operators and the side conditions.

Table 2: Scope of the main claims. "Canonical" means both $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ and $\mathcal{B}_{f,s}$ (with one common sample); "class-wide" means every set-driven operator with characteristic samples throughout the class. G is a reduced good presentation of $L \cap \Sigma^+$ of fan-out $\leq f$ and rank $\leq r_{\max}$.

Claim	Fixed	Operators	Bound and conditions
Theorem A (Theorem 5.7)	f, $r_{\max}$, Σ, s with $s(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG}$	canonical	upper $O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$, every $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ and every G
Theorem B(i) (Proposition 6.1)	f, any s	canonical ($r \geq 1$), class-wide	lower $\Omega(\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G)$ for finite targets; needs $\|\Sigma| \geq 4f+1$ ($\|\Sigma| \geq 2$ if $f = 1$); presentations of rank two
Theorem B(ii) (Corollary 6.2)	f, $r_{\max} \geq 1$, s_{triv}	$\mathcal{B}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$	upper $O(\|G\| \bar{\theta}_G)$ (Yoshinaka [14]); attained if $r_{\max} \geq 2$ and $\|\Sigma| \geq 4f+1$ (≥ 2 if $f = 1$)
Theorem C(i) (Theorem 7.3)	$f = 1$, $r_{\max} \geq 2$, a pseudovariety	$\mathcal{B}_{1,s}^{\leq r_{\max}}$ (Definition 7.2)	uniform polynomial data iff $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$
Theorem C(ii)	$f = 1$, s_U on three letters	canonical, class-wide	lower $3 \cdot 2^n - 1$ for presentations of size and thickness $O(n)$
Corollary 7.6	f, $r_{\max}$, s	set-driven	IPTtD for $\mathbf{LG}$ at every f; at $f = 1$ exactly for $\mathbf{V} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$
Theorem 8.2	any $f \geq 2$, any s	none (membership)	the family of Theorem C(ii) and its letter-disjoint images leave $\mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$, and their forced word is never the only one of its type there; no data bound at $f \geq 2$
Propositions 5.9, 5.10	the alphabets and targets L_{A}, L_{B}	none (membership)	non-context-free, fan-out two, rank two; in $\mathcal{C}_{f,s_{\mathrm{A}}}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$, $\mathcal{C}_{f,s_{\mathrm{B}}}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$ for $f \geq 2$, and for every $f \geq 1$ outside the class of every window–group, respectively window–abelian, typing; no data bound

8 Fan-Out Two: The Lower Bound Does Not Lift

This section shows that the exponential family of Theorem C(ii), and its images under letter-disjoint morphisms, do not carry over to fan-out two (Theorem 8.2).

Lemma 8.1 (Power transfer across two tuple components)**.** *Let $f \geq 2$, $L \in \mathcal{C}_{f,s}^{\mathrm{mcf}}$, $u \in \Sigma^+$, and let $i_0, p \geq 1$ be an eventual index and period of $s(u)$, i.e. $s(u)^{t+p} = s(u)^t$ for $t \geq i_0$. Suppose $i, j \geq i_0$, $\delta \in p\mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, and some word of L contains the factor $u^{i+\delta+j+1}$. Then for all $w_{\mathrm{L}}, w_{\mathrm{R}} \in \Sigma^*$ and $w_{\mathrm{M}} \in \Sigma^+$,*

$$w_{\mathrm{L}} u^i w_{\mathrm{M}} u^{\delta+j} w_{\mathrm{R}} \in L \quad \Longleftrightarrow \quad w_{\mathrm{L}} u^{i+\delta} w_{\mathrm{M}} u^j w_{\mathrm{R}} \in L.$$

Proof. Write the given word as $y u^{i+\delta+j+1} z$. The tuples $\vec{x} = (u^i, u^{\delta+j})$ and $\vec{x}' = (u^{i+\delta}, u^j)$ have the same componentwise s-types by eventual periodicity. They also have the common admissible accepting context $E = y\Box_1 u \Box_2 z$, since $E[\vec{x}] = E[\vec{x}'] = y u^{i+\delta+j+1} z \in L$. The (f,s)-condition thus equates their two-component distributions. Test them in the admissible context $w_{\mathrm{L}}\Box_1 w_{\mathrm{M}} \Box_2 w_{\mathrm{R}}$; the condition $w_{\mathrm{M}} \neq \varepsilon$ is essential. □

Theorem 8.2 (The doubling families do not lift)**.** *Let $s : \Sigma^+ \twoheadrightarrow \mathsf{S}$ be any fixed finite-semigroup typing, let $u_{\mathtt{a}}, u_{\mathtt{b}}, u_{\mathtt{c}} \in \Sigma^+$ be letter-disjoint, let φ be the morphism $\mathtt{a} \mapsto u_{\mathtt{a}}$, $\mathtt{b} \mapsto u_{\mathtt{b}}$, $\mathtt{c} \mapsto u_{\mathtt{c}}$, and*

let $H_n := \varphi(L_n)$ for the family L_n of Proposition 7.1 (so $H_n = L_n$ when φ is the identity). Let $n \geq 2|\mathsf{S}| + 2$ and $f \geq 2$. Every $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ containing $\varphi(W_n)$ contains another word with the same type, the same Parikh vector and no letter of $u_{\mathtt{c}}$. In particular $H_n \notin \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$, and in no member of $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ is $\varphi(W_n)$ the only word of its type.

Proof. The morphism φ is injective, and a word of H_n without the letters of $u_{\mathtt{c}}$ is the image of a word of L_n without $\mathtt{c}$, so $\varphi(W_n)$ is the only such word. Choose an eventual index $i_0 \geq 1$ and period $p \geq 1$ for $s(u_{\mathtt{b}})$ with $i_0 + p \leq |\mathsf{S}| + 1$; then $n \geq 2i_0 + p + 1$. Put $i = i_0$, $\delta = p$ and $j = n - i - \delta - 1 \geq i_0$. The word $\varphi(W_n) = u_{\mathtt{b}}\,\varphi(W_{n-1})\,\varphi(W_{n-1})\,u_{\mathtt{b}}$ starts with $u_{\mathtt{b}}^n u_{\mathtt{a}}$, so it contains $u_{\mathtt{b}}^{i+\delta+j+1}$. Let $u_{\mathtt{b}}^i$ be the i copies of $u_{\mathtt{b}}$ after the first one, and let $u_{\mathtt{b}}^{\delta+j}$ be the $\delta + j \leq n - 1$ copies immediately before the first $u_{\mathtt{a}}$ of the second copy of $\varphi(W_{n-1})$, which is preceded by at least $n - 1$ copies of $u_{\mathtt{b}}$. Then

$$\varphi(W_n) = w_{\mathrm{L}} u_{\mathtt{b}}^i w_{\mathrm{M}} u_{\mathtt{b}}^{\delta+j} w_{\mathrm{R}}$$

with $w_{\mathrm{L}} = u_{\mathtt{b}}$ and $w_{\mathrm{M}} \neq \varepsilon$ containing the first $u_{\mathtt{a}}$. Let $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ contain $\varphi(W_n)$. By Lemma 8.1, $w' := w_{\mathrm{L}} u_{\mathtt{b}}^{i+\delta} w_{\mathrm{M}} u_{\mathtt{b}}^j w_{\mathrm{R}} \in L$. The two filled tuples have equal componentwise types, so $s(w') = s(\varphi(W_n))$; w' has the Parikh vector of $\varphi(W_n)$ and no letter of $u_{\mathtt{c}}$, but begins with $u_{\mathtt{b}}^{n+\delta} u_{\mathtt{a}}$, not $u_{\mathtt{b}}^n u_{\mathtt{a}}$, so $w' \neq \varphi(W_n)$ since $u_{\mathtt{a}}$ and $u_{\mathtt{b}}$ have no common letter. For $L = H_n$ this contradicts the uniqueness of $\varphi(W_n)$ shown above. □

Remark 8.3. Power transfer preserves the total length and Parikh vector of the word, so it does not show that rare-type representatives are short; it only excludes the family of Proposition 7.1 and its letter-disjoint images, also after words are added.

9 Conclusion and an Open Problem

Theorem A establishes $O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$ characteristic-data length for local-group typings at every fixed fan-out, using simultaneous noncommutative shortening. Non-CFL targets distinguish the local-group, window–group and window–abelian regimes in class coverage (Propositions 5.9, 5.10). Theorem B proves the linear-factor lower bound under the stated alphabet conditions, and Theorem C gives the exact fan-out-one pseudovariety boundary. The doubling family does not lift to fan-out two (Theorem 8.2).

Open Problem 9.1 (The boundary at fan-out two). Fix $f \geq 2$ and $r_{\max} \geq 2$. Is **LG** the pseudovariety boundary at fan-out f, that is, does every pseudovariety of finite semigroups not contained in **LG** fail to have uniform polynomial characteristic-data length at fan-out f and rank $r_{\max}$ (Definition 7.2)?

The sufficient direction holds at every fan-out (Theorem 5.7). Every pseudovariety outside **LG** contains U_1 (Theorem B.4), so the converse would follow from superpolynomial data for one fixed U_1-typing. By Proposition 4.6, superpolynomial shortest representatives of a realized type would suffice; the doubling family cannot serve as the witness (Theorem 8.2). For a different observation-size invariant, possible uniform stabilization arities are 1, 2 and ∞ [24].

Tightness of the exponents. In $O(\|G\|^2 \bar{\theta}_G)$, for window–group and local-group typings alike, one factor $\|G\|$ counts the witness words and the other bounds root-to-leaf paths in a λ-minimal derivation by the number of node labels (Lemma 5.1). The path factor is genuine for the witness construction: the grammars $S \to SS \mid \mathtt{a} \mid \mathtt{b} \mid A_0 \mid \cdots \mid A_n$, $A_0 \to \mathtt{b}$, $A_i \to \mathtt{a} \mid A_{i-1}\mathtt{b}$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$ generate $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}\}^+$ with $\|G_n\| = 10n + 16$ and $\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = 2$, but $\mathtt{b}^{n+1}$ is the only yield of A_n of $s_{1,1}$-type $\langle \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{b} \rangle$, so $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G_n, s_{1,1}) \geq n + 1$. For this target, however, $\tau(G_n, s_{1,1}) \leq 2$ (Corollary 4.8), so the

example bounds the witness method, not the data. For the trivial typing the upper bound $O(\|G\|\bar{\theta}_G)$ is attained by the marker families (Corollary 6.2); for every typing with $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$ the remaining gap is a single factor $\|G\|$, a gap between the known examples and the bounds rather than a proved ratio. Neither lower-bound argument closes it: for a fixed typing the rare-type argument yields at most $|\mathsf{S}|(t_{\mathrm{typ}}+1)$, and the marker families consist of $O(\|G\|)$ words of length $\bar{\theta}_G = t_{\mathrm{typ}}$. For noncommutative groups the constant $M_{\mathbb{G},f}$ is doubly exponential in f because of the Ramsey-type homogenization (Lemma A.8); $|\mathbb{G}|$ owners suffice at $f = 1$, and whether absolute constants $A, B > 0$ exist such that $c_{\mathbb{G},f} \le A(|\mathbb{G}|^f)^B$ for all finite groups $\mathbb{G}$ and all $f \ge 2$ (in particular, with a polynomial degree independent of f) is open.

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Data availability

No empirical dataset is associated with this theoretical paper. All proofs are given in full.

A Simultaneous Block Replacement in Finite Groups

This appendix proves Proposition 5.2, used in Lemmas 5.3 and B.8. The abelian case is a zero-sum argument. The general case never commutes factors; it has three parts: an order classification for homogeneous point configurations (Lemma A.4), an interval selection by boundary states (Lemma A.5), and a Ramsey-type extraction of homogeneous indices (Lemmas A.7 and A.8).

Roadmap of the general case. For Lemma A.2(b), we first homogenize the between-owner order (Lemmas A.7 and A.8); this yields at most f monotone class regions (Lemma A.4). Boundary states $\eta_p = P_p Q_p^{-1}$ then select an interval whose replacement preserves every ordered row product (Lemma A.5). Owners discarded during homogenization keep their original values; their blocks become constants. Example A.6 illustrates the two possible orientations.

Definition A.1 (Block-replacement family)**.** Let $\mathbb{G}$ be a finite group and $f \ge 1$. A *block-replacement family* of width f over $\mathbb{G}$ with index set $[m]$ consists of $d \le f$ *lines*; on line ϱ, a left-to-right sequence

of blocks $\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,1},\dots,\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,q_\varrho}$ and constants $a_{\varrho,0},\dots,a_{\varrho,q_\varrho}\in\mathbb{G}$; for every block $\mathfrak{b}$ an *owner* $o(\mathfrak{b})\in[m]$ and two values $x_\mathfrak{b},x'_\mathfrak{b}\in\mathbb{G}$; every index owns at most f blocks. For $J\subseteq[m]$ put

$$\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J):=a_{\varrho,0}\,y_{\varrho,1}\,a_{\varrho,1}\cdots y_{\varrho,q_\varrho}\,a_{\varrho,q_\varrho},\qquad y_{\varrho,j}:=\begin{cases}x'_{\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,j}}, & o(\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,j})\in J,\\ x_{\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,j}}, & o(\mathfrak{b}_{\varrho,j})\notin J.\end{cases}$$

Lemma A.2 (Block replacement)**.** *In a block-replacement family of width f over $\mathbb{G}$ there is a nonempty $J\subseteq[m]$ with $\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J)=\mathrm{val}_\varrho(\emptyset)$ for every line ϱ, provided that either* (a) *$\mathbb{G}$ is abelian and $m>\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)$, or* (b) *$\mathbb{G}$ is arbitrary and $m\ge M_{\mathbb{G},f}$, or* (c) *$\mathbb{G}$ is arbitrary, $f=1$ and $m\ge|\mathbb{G}|$, with d and $M_{\mathbb{G},f}$ as in Section 5.1.*

Proof of (a). Write $\mathbb{G}$ additively. By commutativity $\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J)-\mathrm{val}_\varrho(\emptyset)=\sum_{i\in J}\delta_{i,\varrho}$, where $\delta_{i,\varrho}$ is the sum of $x'_\mathfrak{b}-x_\mathfrak{b}$ over the blocks $\mathfrak{b}$ of line ϱ owned by i. The sequence $(\delta_i)_{i\in[m]}$ with $\delta_i:=(\delta_{i,\varrho})_\varrho\in\mathbb{G}^d$ has length $m>\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)\ge\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^d)$ ($\mathbb{G}^d$ embeds in $\mathbb{G}^f$), so it has a nonempty zero-sum subsequence $(\delta_i)_{i\in J}$. □

Remark A.3 (Size of the zero-sum constant). The prefix-sum pigeonhole gives $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)\le|\mathbb{G}|^f-1$, but much more is true. Write $\mathbb{G}\cong C_{q_1}\oplus\cdots\oplus C_{q_\ell}$ and $q=\exp(\mathbb{G})\ge2$. Then

$$f\sum_{i=1}^{\ell}(q_i-1)\;\le\;\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)\;\le\;(q-1)+q\log\frac{|\mathbb{G}|^f}{q},$$

where the lower bound is attained by a basis sequence and the upper bound is due to van Emde Boas and Kruyswijk [33, Proposition 5.1.8 and Theorem 5.5.5]; for a p-group the lower bound is an equality [33, Theorem 5.5.9]. Hence $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^f)=O(\exp(\mathbb{G})\,f\log|\mathbb{G}|)$; for $\mathbb{G}=C_2$ the antichain bound drops from 2^f-1 to f. Since zero-sum-free sequences of length $\mathsf{d}(\mathbb{G}^d)$ exist, the argument cannot do better; we do not claim that a grammar realizes them.

A.1 Arbitrary Finite Groups: Order Homogenization

Lemma A.4 (A homogeneous block-order lemma)**.** *Let $\mathcal{T}$ be a finite set of types and $n\ge3$, and let (t,i), $t\in\mathcal{T}$, $i\in[n]$, be distinct points on a line. Suppose that* (i) *the order of (t,i) and (u,i) does not depend on i, and* (ii) *for each ordered pair (t,u), including $t=u$, the order of (t,i) and (u,j) is the same for all $i<j$. Then $\mathcal{T}$ is partitioned into classes such that: the points of each class occupy a consecutive region containing no other points; each class has a direction (increasing or decreasing in i); and its region consists of n successive* chunks*, one per index in that direction, each containing exactly one point of every type of the class, in an order independent of the index.*

Proof. By (ii) with $t=u$, the points of each type are monotone in i. For distinct t,u let X mean $(t,i)<(u,j)$ and Y mean $(u,i)<(t,j)$ for $i<j$; both are constant by (ii).

Both increasing. $X\wedge Y$ puts all points of index i of both types before those of index $j>i$ (*interleaved by rank*). Under $X\wedge\neg Y$ all comparisons of different indices put t left of u, and so do equal indices, since $(u,i)<(t,i)$ would give $(t,1)<(t,2)<(u,1)<(t,1)$; so t and u are *separated*. $\neg X\wedge Y$ is symmetric, and $\neg X\wedge\neg Y$ gives $(t,1)<(t,2)<(u,1)<(u,2)<(t,1)$.

t increasing, u decreasing. $X\wedge Y$ gives $(t,2)<(u,3)<(u,1)<(t,2)$ and $\neg X\wedge\neg Y$ gives $(t,3)<(u,2)<(t,1)<(t,3)$. Under $X\wedge\neg Y$ the comparisons of different indices put t left of u, and $(u,i)<(t,i)$ would give $(t,1)<(u,2)<(u,1)<(t,1)$; so they are separated, and $\neg X\wedge Y$ is symmetric. Reversing indices covers two decreasing types.

Thus two types are separated, or have the same direction and are interleaved. Interleaving is transitive: if t,u and u,v are interleaved (all increasing, say) but t,v are separated, then

$(v,1) < (u,2) < (t,3) < (v,1)$ if t is left of v, and $(t,1) < (u,2) < (v,3) < (t,1)$ otherwise. So interleaving is an equivalence relation. A type outside a class is separated from every type of the class and lies on the same side of all of them, since otherwise two interleaved types would be separated; hence class regions contain no other points. Inside a class, interleaving gives the chunks, and (i) gives the within-chunk order. □

Lemma A.5 (Simultaneous finite-group interval shortening)**.** *Let $\mathbb{G}$ be a finite group and consider a block-replacement family of width f over $\mathbb{G}$ with $n \geq \max\{3, |\mathbb{G}|^f\}$ indices, in which all indices have the same number of blocks, on the same lines, in the same within-index order, and in which, for every two block positions t, u on a common line (allowing $t = u$), the truth value of "block t of index i lies left of block u of index j" is the same for all $i < j$. Then a nonempty interval J of indices satisfies $\mathrm{val}_\varrho(J) = \mathrm{val}_\varrho(\emptyset)$ for every line ϱ.*

Proof. Apply Lemma A.4 on each line; there are $d_{\mathrm{reg}} \leq f$ class regions in total. Fix a region $\mathcal{Q}$ and number its chunks $1, \ldots, n$ from left to right. Assign constants between chunks to the chunk on their left, and absorb fixed constants at the ends of the region into its first or last chunk. Each chunk has original and replacement products with the *same* fixed constants in the same order. Let P_p be the original value of chunks $1, \ldots, p$ and Q_p their value when all of them are replaced ($P_0 = Q_0 = 1_{\mathbb{G}}$), and put $\eta_p^{\mathcal{Q}} := P_p Q_p^{-1}$. Replacing exactly chunks $p+1, \ldots, p'$ gives the ordered value $P_p\,(Q_p^{-1}Q_{p'})\,(P_{p'}^{-1}P_n)$, which equals P_n iff $P_pQ_p^{-1} \cdot Q_{p'}P_{p'}^{-1} = 1_{\mathbb{G}}$, that is, iff $\eta_p^{\mathcal{Q}} = \eta_{p'}^{\mathcal{Q}}$; no factors are commuted. The order in $\eta_p^{\mathcal{Q}} = P_pQ_p^{-1}$ is forced by the position of the replaced chunks between an original prefix and an original suffix; the element $Q_p^{-1}P_p$ need not detect this in a noncommutative group. If $\mathcal{Q}$ is increasing, the owners in $(a,b]$ occupy exactly chunks $(a,b]$; if it is decreasing, chunks $(n-b, n-a]$. For $j = 0, \ldots, n$ let the state be the vector in $\mathbb{G}^{d_{\mathrm{reg}}}$ whose $\mathcal{Q}$-entry is $\eta_j^{\mathcal{Q}}$ for increasing and $\eta_{n-j}^{\mathcal{Q}}$ for decreasing regions. Since $n+1 > |\mathbb{G}|^{d_{\mathrm{reg}}}$, two states coincide, at $a < b$. Replacing the owners $a+1, \ldots, b$ then preserves every region value, and nothing outside the regions changes. □

Example A.6 (Opposite orientations and noncommuting values). In S_3 let $\sigma_1 = (12)$, $\sigma_2 = (23)$. Three owners have one block B_i on row 1 and one block W_i on row 2, so the family has width two:

$$\text{row 1: } B_1\,\sigma_1\,B_2\,\sigma_1\,B_3, \qquad \text{row 2: } W_3\,\sigma_2\,W_2\,\sigma_2\,W_1,$$

so row 1 is one increasing class and row 2 one decreasing class. Originally $B_i = W_i = 1$, and both rows have value 1. Let owner 1 have the trivial replacement $B_1' = B_1$, $W_1' = W_1$, and replace exactly owners $J = \{2,3\}$ by $B_2' = \sigma_2$, $W_2' = \sigma_2\sigma_1\sigma_2$, $B_3' = \sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_1$, $W_3' = \sigma_1$. Then row 1 becomes $\sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_2\sigma_1 \cdot \sigma_1\sigma_2\sigma_1 = 1$ and row 2 becomes $\sigma_1\sigma_2 \cdot \sigma_2\sigma_1\sigma_2 \cdot \sigma_2 = 1$, computed in order. In the notation of the proof, $(a,b] = (1,3]$ and $\eta_1 = \eta_3 = 1$ on row 1, while $\eta_{3-b} = \eta_0 = 1 = \eta_2 = \eta_{3-a}$ on row 2: one owner interval matches two different boundary-index orientations, although neither replaced owner preserves its own contribution. The example illustrates the mechanism; with three owners it is far below the threshold of Proposition 5.2, and the good owner interval is found by direct computation.

Lemma A.7 (Two monotone sequences)**.** *Let $m \geq 3$, $m' \geq (m-1)^2 + 1$ and $\mathrm{lt} : \{(i,j) : 1 \leq i < j \leq m'\} \to \{0,1\}$ be monotone in each argument with fixed directions: for each fixed i it is monotone in j, for each fixed j monotone in i, and each of these two directions is the same for all values of the fixed argument. Then* lt *is constant on the pairs $i < j$ of some $I \subseteq [m']$ with $|I| = m$.*

Proof. Replacing lt by $1 - \mathrm{lt}$ if necessary, rows are nondecreasing in j. It suffices to find an index set of size at least m, since constancy persists in subsets.

If columns are nonincreasing in i, let $\mathrm{nx}(i) := \min\{j > i : \mathrm{lt}(i,j) = 1\}$ (∞ if none); nx is nondecreasing. The chain $i_1 = 1$, $i_{r+1} = \mathrm{nx}(i_r)$ satisfies $\mathrm{lt}(i_a, i_b) = 1$ for $a < b$; if it has m terms we are done. Otherwise its at most $m-1$ terms cut $[m']$ into at most $m-1$ intervals $[i_r, i_{r+1})$, $[i_L, m']$, one of which has at least $m'/(m-1) > m-1$, hence at least m, indices, and inside it $j < \mathrm{nx}(i_r) \le \mathrm{nx}(i)$ gives $\mathrm{lt}(i,j) = 0$.

If columns are nondecreasing, let i^* be the least index with $\mathrm{lt}(i^*, i^*+1) = 1$ ($i^* = m'$ if none). Then $\mathrm{lt}(i,j) = 1$ for $i^* \le i < j$ and $\mathrm{lt}(i,j) \le \mathrm{lt}(j-1,j) = 0$ for $i < j \le i^*$, and one of $[1, i^*]$, $[i^*, m']$ has at least $(m'+1)/2 \ge m$ indices because $(m-1)^2 + 1 \ge 2m - 1$ for $m \ge 3$. □

Lemma A.8 (Polynomial order homogenization)**.** *Let $n_0 \ge 3$, $h_0 := n_0$ and $h_{q+1} := (h_q - 1)^2 + 1$, so $h_q \le n_0^{2^q}$. Let $\mathcal{T}$ be a finite set of types, each assigned to a line, and for $i \in [n]$ and $t \in \mathcal{T}$ let $p_t(i)$ be a point on the line of t, the points on each line being distinct. Let $\mathcal{O}$ be the set of ordered pairs (t,u), $t = u$ allowed, of types on a common line. If $n \ge h_{|\mathcal{O}|}$, there is $I \subseteq [n]$ with $|I| = n_0$ such that for every $(t,u) \in \mathcal{O}$ the truth value of $p_t(i) < p_u(j)$ is the same for all $i < j$ in I.*

Proof. Treat the pairs one at a time, the pairs (t,t) first; each step passes from an index set of size at least $(m-1)^2 + 1$ to a subset of size at least m, and earlier homogeneity persists in subsets. For (t,t), Erdős–Szekeres gives a monotone subsequence of length m. For $t \ne u$ (both now monotone), relabel the current indices $1, \dots, m'$ and put $\mathrm{lt}(i,j) := [p_t(i) < p_u(j)]$ for $i < j$. For fixed i, lt is monotone in j in the direction of p_u; for fixed j, monotone in i in the direction opposite to p_t. Since $m \ge m_0 = n_0 \ge 3$, Lemma A.7 applies. □

Proof of Lemma A.2(c)*.* An index owning no block can be chosen alone, so let every index own one block; at $f = 1$ all blocks lie on the single line. Renumber the indices by the positions of their blocks, so that they form one increasing region with one block per chunk. As in the proof of Lemma A.5, replacing exactly the indices $a+1, \dots, b$ preserves the line value iff $\eta_a = \eta_b$, and the $m + 1 > |\mathbb{G}|$ values $\eta_0, \dots, \eta_m \in \mathbb{G}$ cannot all be distinct. □

Proof of Lemma A.2(b)*.* An index owning no block can be chosen alone, so assume every index owns a block. The *pattern* of an index records the number of its blocks, the line of each, and their order on shared lines; there are at most $f \cdot f^f \cdot f! = \mathcal{P}_f$ patterns, so at least $N_{\mathbb{G},f}^{2^{f^2}}$ indices share one. Absorb the blocks of all other indices into the constants: these indices are never replaced, so their blocks keep their original values in every row. The blocks of the common pattern give at most f types and at most f^2 ordered pairs on common lines, so Lemma A.8 with $n_0 = N_{\mathbb{G},f}$ yields $N_{\mathbb{G},f}$ indices with homogeneous order comparisons. The blocks of the indices discarded in this extraction are absorbed into the constants in the same way. The common pattern fixes the order of the blocks of one index, which is hypothesis (i) of Lemma A.4, and Lemma A.8 gives hypothesis (ii); a comparison with $i > j$ is the negation of the comparison for the reversed pair, since the points are distinct. The remaining $N_{\mathbb{G},f}$ indices then satisfy the hypotheses of Lemma A.5, whose interval is the required J. □

Ordered product-one viewpoint. For $f = 1$ each owner has one block on one row. Let A_b be the original row prefix strictly before block b, and set $h_b := A_b x_b' x_b^{-1} A_b^{-1}$. Direct cancellation gives, for any J,

$$\mathrm{val}(J) = \Big(\prod_{b:\, o(b) \in J}^{\text{row order}} h_b \Big) \mathrm{val}(\emptyset).$$

Thus choosing owners is an ordered product-one subsequence problem, related to the classical work of Olson and White [32]. This is distinct from the unordered small Davenport constant; for $f \ge 2$

the same owners must work simultaneously across rows with different orders. We do not need a sharp product-one subsequence threshold here.

For fixed f, $M_{\mathbb{G},f} = \mathcal{P}_f \max\{3, |\mathbb{G}|^f\}^{2^{f^2}}$ is polynomial in $|\mathbb{G}|$; its degree $f \cdot 2^{f^2}$ is exponential in f^2, so $M_{\mathbb{G},f}$ itself is doubly exponential in f.

B Local-Group Coordinates and MCFG Block Shortening

LG is always tested on the positive image $\mathsf{S} = \widehat{s}(\Sigma^+)$. The classical identity $\mathbf{LG} = \mathbf{Grp} * \mathbf{D}$ places it within the sliding-window and delay theory [35, 36], and the exclusion of $U_1 = \{1, \zeta\}$ ($\zeta^2 = \zeta$) is [34, Proposition 2.3]. Write x^ω for the idempotent power of an element x of a finite semigroup. Equivalently, **LG** is defined by the single pseudo-identity $(x^\omega y x^\omega)^\omega = x^\omega$: for an idempotent $e = x^\omega$ the finite monoid $e\mathsf{S}e = \{eye : y \in \mathsf{S}\}$ is a group exactly when e is its only idempotent, and every idempotent has the form x^ω. The coordinates below are a self-contained implementation of this algebra, not a new characterization; what is specific to MCFG learning is the factorization of group values into fixed separators and replaceable blocks (Lemma B.2). Throughout, $k \geq 1$, $\mathbb{G}$ is a finite group, $\lambda_{k,\nu}$ is as in Definition 5.6, a word is *short* if $|w| < 2k$ (recorded exactly by $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$) and *long* otherwise, and for $x, y \in \Sigma^k$ we put $\Delta_\nu(x, y) := \prod_{i=1}^{k} \nu((xy)[i..i+k])$, the ordered product over the k factors of length $k+1$ of xy that start in x.

Pumping. For a finite semigroup T, every product of at least $|\mathsf{T}|$ elements lies in $\mathsf{T}^1 E(\mathsf{T}) \mathsf{T}^1$ [34, Lemma 2.2], [25]: either two of its first $|\mathsf{T}|$ prefix products coincide, $t_i = t_j$ with $i < j$, and then $t_i = t_i x^\omega$ for the product x of the factors $i+1, \ldots, j$; or these prefix products exhaust T and one of them is idempotent. All three uses below (Lemmas B.3 and B.5, Theorem B.4) rest on this fact.

Lemma B.1 (Sliding-factor maps are morphisms)**.** *$\lambda_{k,\nu}(uv)$ is a function of $\lambda_{k,\nu}(u)$ and $\lambda_{k,\nu}(v)$; hence $\lambda_{k,\nu}$ is a morphism onto a finite monoid $M_{k,\nu}$ with at most $|\Sigma|^{<2k} + |\Sigma|^{2k}|\mathbb{G}|$ elements. For long u, v,*

$$\lambda_{k,\nu}(uv) = \big(\langle \mathrm{pref}_k\, u, \mathrm{suf}_k\, v\rangle,\ \gamma_{k,\nu}(u)\, \Delta_\nu(\mathrm{suf}_k\, u, \mathrm{pref}_k\, v)\, \gamma_{k,\nu}(v)\big).$$

Proof. The window component is a morphism. For long u, v the factors of length $k+1$ of uv are, in order, those of u, the k factors starting in the last k positions of u (inside $\mathrm{suf}_k(u)\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$), and those of v. If u is short and v long, the factors starting in u lie inside $u\,\mathrm{pref}_k(v)$ and the others are those of v; the case of long u and short v is symmetric; and if both are short, uv is determined exactly. □

Lemma B.2 (Block decomposition)**.** *Let $w = x_0 \mathfrak{b}_1 x_1 \cdots \mathfrak{b}_q x_q$ and $w' = x_0 \mathfrak{b}'_1 x_1 \cdots \mathfrak{b}'_q x_q$ with $\widehat{s}_{k,k}(\mathfrak{b}'_j) = \widehat{s}_{k,k}(\mathfrak{b}_j)$ for all j. Then $\widehat{s}_{k,k}(w') = \widehat{s}_{k,k}(w)$, and if w is long there are $z_0, \ldots, z_q \in \mathbb{G}$, depending only on the x_j and the window types of the $\mathfrak{b}_j$, with*

$$\gamma_{k,\nu}(w) = z_0\, \gamma_{k,\nu}(\mathfrak{b}_1)\, z_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,\nu}(\mathfrak{b}_q)\, z_q, \qquad \gamma_{k,\nu}(w') = z_0\, \gamma_{k,\nu}(\mathfrak{b}'_1)\, z_1 \cdots \gamma_{k,\nu}(\mathfrak{b}'_q)\, z_q.$$

Proof. The window claim holds because $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$ is a morphism. A short block equals its replacement and is absorbed into the fixed words, so let all blocks be long. A factor of length $k+1$ either lies inside some block or meets every block it touches in a prefix or suffix of length at most k; factors of the second kind are spelled by the fixed words and the first and last k letters of the blocks, so they are the same in w and w' and occur in the same order. Ordered by starting position, the factors inside $\mathfrak{b}_j$ form one run with product $\gamma_{k,\nu}(\mathfrak{b}_j)$; let z_j be the ordered product of the factors between consecutive runs. □

Lemma B.3 (Sliding-factor coordinates)**.** *Let s be a typing whose positive image S has all its idempotents in its minimal ideal $\mathsf{K} = \mathcal{M}(\mathbb{H}; I, \Lambda; \mathsf{P})$, a Rees matrix semigroup over a group $\mathbb{H}$ with sandwich matrix $\mathsf{P} = (p_{ji})_{j\in\Lambda, i\in I}$, whose elements $(i, \gamma, j) \in I \times \mathbb{H} \times \Lambda$ multiply by $(i, \gamma, j)(i', \gamma', j') = (i, \gamma p_{ji'} \gamma', j')$. Let $k \geq 1$ satisfy $\mathsf{S}^k \subseteq \mathsf{K}$ (by pumping, $\mathsf{S}^{|\mathsf{S}|} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^1 E(\mathsf{S}) \mathsf{S}^1 \subseteq \mathsf{K}$, so $k = |\mathsf{S}|$ will do; the least such k gives the smallest windows). There is $\nu : \Sigma^{k+1} \to \mathbb{H}$ such that every w with $|w| \geq 2k$ satisfies*

$$s(w) = \big(\mathrm{row}(s(\mathrm{pref}_k\, w)),\ \mathrm{grp}(s(\mathrm{pref}_k\, w))\, \gamma_{k,\nu}(w),\ \mathrm{col}(s(\mathrm{suf}_k\, w))\big), \tag{$\star$}$$

where row, grp, col *are the three coordinates of an element of K. In particular $s(w)$ is determined by its first and last k letters and an ordered product in $\mathbb{H}$.*

Proof. (1) Coordinates. Fix $i_0 \in I$; for $j \in \Lambda$ the element $r_j := (i_0, p_{ji_0}^{-1}, j)$ is a right identity for the elements of K with Λ-coordinate j. For $y \in \mathsf{S}$ write $r_j y = (i', \gamma', j')$ and $\mathrm{act}(j, y) := p_{ji'}\gamma'$; then $(i, \gamma, j)y = (i, \gamma\, \mathrm{act}(j, y), j')$, so right multiplication fixes the I-coordinate. Dually, left multiplication fixes the Λ-coordinate of an element of K: for any $j'' \in \Lambda$ the idempotent $e' := (i, p_{j''i}^{-1}, j'') \in \mathsf{K}$ satisfies $e'(i, \gamma, j) = (i, \gamma, j)$, so $y(i, \gamma, j) = (ye')(i, \gamma, j)$ with $ye' \in \mathsf{K}$, and the Rees product of two elements of K has the Λ-coordinate of its right factor.

(2) Group coordinate. Let $w = a_1 \cdots a_m$ with letters a_t, $m \geq 2k$, and $s(a_1 \cdots a_k) = (i, \gamma, j_k)$. For $t \geq k$ the Λ-coordinate j_t of $s(a_1 \cdots a_t)$ equals that of $s(a_{t-k+1} \cdots a_t)$ by $\mathsf{S}^k \subseteq \mathsf{K}$ and (1). Put $\nu(F) := \mathrm{act}\big(\mathrm{col}(s(F[1..k])), s(F[k+1])\big)$. Applying the right-action identity for $t = k, \ldots, m-1$ in order gives $s(w) = (i,\ \gamma \prod_{t=k}^{m-1} \nu(a_{t-k+1} \cdots a_{t+1}),\ j_m)$, and the product is $\gamma_{k,\nu}(w)$. □

Theorem B.4 (Local-group criteria in sliding-factor coordinates)**.** *For a typing s with positive image S the following are equivalent:* (i) $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$*;* (ii) S *has no subsemigroup isomorphic to U_1;* (iii) *every idempotent of S lies in the minimal ideal of S;* (iv) *s is local-group-determined, and one may take $k = |\mathsf{S}|$, or any k with $\mathsf{S}^k = \mathsf{K}$.*

Proof. For completeness, we verify the classical equivalences (cf. [34, Proposition 2.3]). If $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LG}$ then S cannot contain $U_1 = \{e, z\}$, since z would be an idempotent distinct from the identity e of the group $e\mathsf{S}e$. Conversely, if some $e\mathsf{S}e$ is not a group, choose a nonunit x therein; $x^\omega \neq e$ (otherwise x is a unit), and $\{e, x^\omega\}$ is a copy of U_1. Thus (i) and (ii) are equivalent. If (i) holds, choose an idempotent $v \in \mathsf{K}$. For any idempotent $e \in \mathsf{S}$, the element eve lies in $e\mathsf{S}e \cap \mathsf{K}$, and invertibility in $e\mathsf{S}e$ gives $e = (eve)(eve)^{-1} \in \mathsf{K}$. Conversely, if every idempotent e lies in K, then $e\mathsf{S}e = e\mathsf{K}e$ is a group, since K is completely simple. This proves (i)–(iii). Moreover, if $E(\mathsf{S}) \subseteq \mathsf{K}$ then $\mathsf{S}^k \subseteq \mathsf{S}^1 E(\mathsf{S}) \mathsf{S}^1 \subseteq \mathsf{K}$ for $k = |\mathsf{S}|$ by pumping, while $\mathsf{K} \subseteq \mathsf{S}^k$ by ideality; hence $\mathsf{S}^k = \mathsf{K}$.

(iii)⇒(iv): Lemma B.3 with $k = |\mathsf{S}|$ (or any k with $\mathsf{S}^k = \mathsf{K}$) determines $s(w)$ for $|w| \geq 2k$ from $\lambda_{k,\nu}(w)$, and $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$ records shorter words and ε exactly; so $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{k,\nu}$.

(iv)⇒(i): S is a homomorphic image of $\mathsf{T} := \lambda_{k,\nu}(\Sigma^+)$ and $\mathbf{LG}$ is closed under homomorphic images, so it suffices that $\mathsf{T} \in \mathbf{LG}$. No short element is idempotent (squaring changes the exactly recorded word or makes it long). Let $e = (\langle p, q\rangle, \gamma_e)$ be idempotent. By Lemma B.1, every element of $e\mathsf{T}e$ has window $\langle p, q\rangle$, and long elements with this window multiply by $(\langle p, q\rangle, \gamma)(\langle p, q\rangle, \gamma') = (\langle p, q\rangle, \gamma\Delta\gamma')$, $\Delta := \Delta_\nu(q, p)$. This operation makes $\{\langle p, q\rangle\} \times \mathbb{G}$ a group isomorphic to $\mathbb{G}$ via $\gamma \mapsto \gamma\Delta$, and $e\mathsf{T}e$ is a finite nonempty subsemigroup of it, hence a subgroup. □

Lemma B.5 (Locally trivial–group typings admit window–group refinements)**.** *Let $\Sigma \neq \emptyset$. If $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$, there are $k \geq 1$, a finite group $\mathbb{G}$ and a morphism $g : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{G}$ with $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,k}, g)$; if $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI}$, $\mathbb{G}$ can be trivial.*

Proof. Choose a finite $\mathsf{S}' \in \mathbf{LI}$, a finite group $\mathbb{G}$, a subsemigroup $\mathsf{T} \leq \mathsf{S}' \times \mathbb{G}$ and a surjective morphism $\vartheta : \mathsf{T} \to \mathsf{S}$ (for $\mathsf{S} \in \mathbf{LI}$: $\mathsf{S}' = \mathsf{S}$, $\mathbb{G} = \{1\}$). Choosing for every letter a preimage in T

of its s-image defines morphisms $s' : \Sigma^+ \to \mathsf{S}'$ and g with $\vartheta(s'(w), g(w)) = s(w)$; put $g(\varepsilon) = 1_{\mathbb{G}}$. The subsemigroup $\mathsf{S}_0 := s'(\Sigma^+) \leq \mathsf{S}'$ is locally trivial; let $k := |\mathsf{S}_0|$. For idempotents e, e' of S_0 and $y \in \mathsf{S}_0^1$ one has $eye' = ey(e'ee') = (e(ye')e)e' = ee'$. For $|w| \geq 2k$ write $w = pxz$ with $|p| = |z| = k$. By pumping, $s'(p) = y_1 e y_2$ and $s'(z) = y_3 e' y_4$ with $y_1, \ldots, y_4 \in \mathsf{S}_0^1$ and e, e' idempotent, so $s'(w) = y_1 e\,(y_2\, s'(x)\, y_3)\, e' y_4 = y_1 e e' y_4$ (with $s'(\varepsilon) := 1$), which depends only on $p = \mathrm{pref}_k(w)$ and $z = \mathrm{suf}_k(w)$. Shorter words are recorded exactly by $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$, which also separates ε. Hence equal $(\widehat{s}_{k,k}, g)$-values imply equal (s', g)-values and equal s-values. □

Proposition B.6 (Window–group typings are local-group typings, strictly)**.** (i) *If $\widehat{s} \preceq (\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}, g)$ for a morphism g into a finite group, then $\widehat{s} \preceq \lambda_{\hat{k},\nu}$ with $\hat{k} = \max\{k, \ell, 1\}$ and $\nu(F) := g($last letter of $F)$. Moreover* $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp} \subseteq \mathbf{LG}$.

(ii) *Already for $\Sigma = \{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}\}$ and the typing $s_{\mathtt{ab}} := \lambda_{1,\nu}|_{\Sigma^+}$ with $\nu(\mathtt{ab}) = 1 \in \mathbb{Z}_2$ and $\nu = 0$ otherwise, $s_{\mathtt{ab}}(\Sigma^+) \in \mathbf{LG} \setminus (\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp})$.*

Proof. (i) For $|w| \geq 2\hat{k}$, $g(w) = g(\mathrm{pref}_{\hat{k}}\, w)\, \gamma_{\hat{k},\nu}(w)$, and $\mathrm{pref}_{\hat{k}}, \mathrm{suf}_{\hat{k}}$ determine $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}(w)$; shorter words are recorded exactly. The inclusion holds because **LG** is a pseudovariety containing **LI** ($e\mathsf{T}e = \{e\}$) and **Grp**. (ii) Membership in **LG** follows from Theorem B.4. Let $k, \ell \geq 0$ and let $g' : \Sigma^* \to \mathbb{G}'$ map into an arbitrary finite group. Choose $m \geq k + \ell + 1$ and $n \geq 1$ divisible by the order of $g'(\mathtt{a})$, and put $u = \mathtt{b}^m \mathtt{a}^n \mathtt{b}^m$ and $v = \mathtt{b}^{2m}$. They have equal length-k prefix and length-ℓ suffix, are long for $s_{k,\ell}$, and satisfy $g'(u) = g'(\mathtt{b})^{2m} = g'(v)$, but $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(u) = 1$ and $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(v) = 0$. Thus $s_{\mathtt{ab}}$ is not a window–group typing, and Lemma B.5 excludes $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$. □

Lemma B.7 (Thinned and padded owners)**.** *Fix $k \geq 1$. Consider pairwise disjoint nonempty intervals in at most f words (*rows*), each interval belonging to one of m owners and each owner holding at most f intervals, and suppose that no interval meets the first or last k letters of its row. Then there is a set Q_1 of at least $m/(4kf + 1)$ owners with the following property. For arbitrary nonempty replacement words of the intervals of the owners in Q_1, there are pairwise disjoint* enlarged blocks*, at most f per owner, such that* (a) *each enlarged block contains intervals of exactly one owner in Q_1, and every interval of an owner in Q_1 lies in exactly one enlarged block;* (b) *replacing, inside an enlarged block, the intervals of its owner yields a word of length at least $2k + 1$ with the same first and last k letters as the block, which itself has length at least $2k + 1$; and* (c) *for every $J \subseteq Q_1$, replacing the intervals of the owners in J equals replacing their enlarged blocks as in* (b)*.*

Proof. Join two distinct owners if some interval of one and some interval of the other lie in the same row with fewer than $2k$ letters between them. A neighbouring interval to the right of an interval $[l, r)$ (in cut positions) starts at one of the $2k$ cuts $r, \ldots, r + 2k - 1$, and disjointness and nonemptiness allow at most one interval per cut; the same holds on the left. So each owner has at most $4kf$ neighbours, and greedily choosing an owner and deleting its closed neighbourhood gives an independent set Q_1 of at least $m/(4kf + 1)$ owners.

Enlarge every interval of an owner in Q_1 by k letters on each side; the boundary hypothesis keeps the enlargement inside its row. Intervals of distinct owners in Q_1 are at least $2k$ letters apart, so their enlargements have disjoint interiors; merge overlapping enlargements of the same owner. This gives (a) and does not increase the number of blocks per owner. Let $[l, r)$ be the union of the merged enlargements and l_0 the smallest left end of an interval in it, so $l = l_0 - k$. No interval of an owner in Q_1 meets $[l, l_0)$: one of the same owner would have been merged with a smaller left end, and one of another owner in Q_1 would end at least $2k$ letters before l_0. Symmetrically for the last k letters. Replacing only the owner's intervals therefore keeps the first and last k letters, and the replacement contains at least one nonempty word besides these $2k$ letters, which gives (b). Letters of owners outside Q_1 inside a block are never replaced, so (c) holds for every $J \subseteq Q_1$. □

Lemma B.8 (Short tuples with prescribed local-group type)**.** *Let G be reduced and good of fan-out $\le f$ and rank $\le r_{\max}$, and $\lambda = \lambda_{k,\nu}$ with group $\mathbb{G}$. Put $C^{\mathrm{buf}}_{k,\mathbb{G},f} := 2kf + (4kf+1)c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ and $\bar{n}_\lambda := |V||M_{k,\nu}|^f$. For every $B \in V$ and every realizable $\mathbf{t} \in M^{\mathrm{fan}(B)}_{k,\nu}$ there is $\vec{u} \in L_B(G)$ with $\lambda^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$ and*

$$\|\vec{u}\|_1 \le \beta_\lambda := (r_{\max}+1)\,\bar{\theta}_G\, C^{\mathrm{buf}}_{k,\mathbb{G},f}\,\bar{n}_\lambda.$$

Proof. We verify the hypothesis of Lemma 5.1(ii) with $c = (4kf+1)c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ and $c' = 2kf$, so $c + c' = C^{\mathrm{buf}}_{k,\mathbb{G},f} \ge 1$; with $n_\lambda(G) \le \bar{n}_\lambda$ it gives the bound. Let T be λ-minimal with heavy threshold $b = \bar{\theta}_G$. In each root component of length at least $2k$ mark the first and the last k letters, and in each shorter component mark every letter: at most $2kf$ marks. Let Q be an antichain of heavy nodes. By linearity and nondeletion their components occupy disjoint nonempty intervals of the root components, at most f per node, and at most $2kf$ nodes contain a mark; let Q_0 be the others, so their intervals avoid the first and last k letters of every root component and lie in components of length at least $2k$.

Let $|Q_0| > (4kf+1)c_{\mathbb{G},f}$. Lemma B.7 gives a set $Q_1 \subseteq Q_0$ of more than $c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ owners. For $v \in Q_1$ with nonterminal C_v fix a tuple of $L_{C_v}(G)$ of total length at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ (Lemma 4.1(ii)); its components are nonempty, and no window or group condition is imposed on it. By Lemma B.7(b) every enlarged block and its replacement are long and have the same first and last k letters, hence the same $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$-type. So Lemma B.2, applied with the enlarged blocks, writes $\gamma_{k,\nu}$ of every long root component as an ordered product of the block values and constants that do not depend on which owners are replaced. This is a block-replacement family of width f over $\mathbb{G}$ with more than $c_{\mathbb{G},f}$ owners, and Proposition 5.2 gives a nonempty $J \subseteq Q_1$ preserving every root $\gamma_{k,\nu}$-value.

Replace the subtrees at the nodes of J by derivations of the chosen tuples. This is a derivation from B because J is an antichain, and by Lemma B.7(c) its root components are those of the enlarged-block replacement. Short root components contain no replaced letter and are unchanged; long ones keep their marked first and last k letters and stay long, so their $\widehat{s}_{k,k}$-types are unchanged, and their $\gamma_{k,\nu}$-values are preserved by the choice of J. Hence the root λ-vector is unchanged. □

Substitutability is not used in Lemma B.8.

C Proofs for the Separating Targets

This appendix proves Propositions 5.9 and 5.10. A language $L \subseteq \Sigma^*$ is *strictly 2-local* if there is a set P of pairs over $\Sigma \cup \{\vdash, \dashv\}$ such that $w \in L$ if and only if every pair of adjacent symbols of $\vdash w \dashv$ lies in P.

Lemma C.1 (Strictly 2-local languages are boundary typed)**.** *Every strictly 2-local L is $(f, s_{1,1})$-tuple-substitutable for every f; in particular $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_{1,1}}$, and $L \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ whenever $\widehat{s}_{1,1} \preceq \widehat{s}$.*

Proof. Let $\vec{x}, \vec{y} \in (\Sigma^+)^d$ have equal $s_{1,1}$-types, so corresponding components are identical letters or share first and last letters, and let $E_0[\vec{x}], E_0[\vec{y}] \in L$. Suppose $E[\vec{x}] \in L$. Since the internal separators of E are nonempty, every adjacent pair of $\vdash E[\vec{y}] \dashv$ either lies inside some y_i, and then occurs in $E_0[\vec{y}] \in L$, or joins a first or last letter of some y_i to a symbol of $\vdash E \dashv$, or lies in $\vdash E \dashv$, and then occurs in $\vdash E[\vec{x}] \dashv$. So $E[\vec{y}] \in L$; symmetry and $\widehat{s}_{1,1} \preceq \widehat{s}$ finish the proof (regular languages are MCFLs). □

Proof of Propositions 5.9 and 5.10. Write $\diamond \in \{\mathrm{A}, \mathrm{B}\}$, let $\Sigma^\circ_\diamond$ be $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}$ or $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}\}$, and let $P_\diamond(w)$ be "$\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(w)$ even" or "$g_{\mathrm{B}}(w) = 1$".

(i) Let W be a right-linear (fan-out-one, rank-one, good) grammar for the regular language $\{\varsigma w : \varsigma \in \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\}, w \in (\Sigma_\diamond^\circ)^+, \varsigma = \mathtt{r} \text{ or } P_\diamond(w)\}$; it tracks the last letter and the parity, respectively the value in S_3. Add

$$C \to (\xi_1^1\$\mathtt{1}, \mathtt{3})(W) \mid (\xi_1^1\mathtt{1}, \xi_1^2\mathtt{3})(C), \quad D \to (\mathtt{2},\mathtt{4}) \mid (\xi_1^1\mathtt{2}, \xi_1^2\mathtt{4})(D), \quad S \to (\xi_1^1\xi_2^1\xi_1^2\xi_2^2)(C, D).$$

Then $L_C = \{(\varsigma w\$\mathtt{1}^m, \mathtt{3}^m)\}$, $L_D = \{(\mathtt{2}^n, \mathtt{4}^n)\}$, and S generates $L_\diamond$; the grammar is good (adjacent variables in the start template belong to different children). Intersecting with the regular language $\mathtt{ra}\$\mathtt{1}^+\mathtt{2}^+\mathtt{3}^+\mathtt{4}^+$ and erasing $\mathtt{ra}\$$ gives $C_\times$, which is not context-free; context-free languages are closed under both operations, so $L_\diamond$ is not context-free.

(ii) $L_\diamond = Q_\diamond \cap \Pi_\diamond \cap \varphi_\times^{-1}(0)$ with $Q_\diamond = \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\}(\Sigma_\diamond^\circ)^+\$\mathtt{1}^+\mathtt{2}^+\mathtt{3}^+\mathtt{4}^+$ and $\Pi_\diamond$ the set of nonempty words that begin with $\mathtt{r}$, or begin with $\mathtt{l}$ and satisfy $P_\diamond$ for the whole word. On $Q_\diamond$ the condition $P_\diamond$ of the whole word is that of w: no factor $\mathtt{ab}$ meets ς, \$ or the digits, and g_B is trivial on all other letters. $Q_\diamond$ is strictly 2-local (its pairs are $\vdash\varsigma$, ςx, xy, $x\$$, $\$\mathtt{1}$, $\mathtt{11},\mathtt{12},\mathtt{22},\mathtt{23},\mathtt{33},\mathtt{34},\mathtt{44}$, $\mathtt{4}\dashv$ for $\varsigma \in \{\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}\}$, $x, y \in \Sigma_\diamond^\circ$) and $\widehat{s}_{1,1} \preceq \widehat{s}_\diamond$, so Lemma C.1 applies. $\Pi_\diamond$ is a union of $s_\diamond$-classes: $s_\diamond$ records the first letter, and for words of length at least two the parity of $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}$, respectively the value of g_B (the one-letter words $\mathtt{l},\mathtt{r}$ lie in $\Pi_\diamond$); so item (c) after Definition 2.8 applies. Proposition 2.9 handles $\varphi_\times^{-1}(0)$ and the intersection; with (i), $L_\diamond \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_\diamond}$ for $f \geq 2$. s_A is local-group-determined, so its positive image lies in **LG** by Theorem B.4.

(iii) for A. Let $\hat{k} = \max\{k, \ell, 1\}$, $q \geq 2$ an even multiple of the exponent of the group of g', $u = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{abc})^q\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$ and $v = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{bac})^q\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$. Both are long for $\widehat{s}_{k,\ell}$ with prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$ and suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$, and $g'(u) = g'(\mathtt{a})^{2\hat{k}} = g'(v)$; so $s'(u) = s'(v)$. But $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(u) = q$ is even and $\#_{\mathtt{ab}}(v) = 1$ (only at $\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}\mathtt{b}$). With $z = \$\mathtt{1234}$, Lemma 5.8 applies. A typing with positive image in $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$ satisfies the hypothesis by Lemma B.5.

(iii) for B. Let $\hat{k} \geq \max\{k, \ell, 1\}$ be even, $u = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{ab})^3\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$ and $v = \mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}(\mathtt{ab})^2\mathtt{ba}\,\mathtt{a}^{\hat{k}}$. They have the same prefix $\mathtt{a}^k$, suffix $\mathtt{a}^\ell$ and Parikh vector, so $s'(u) = s'(v)$ for abelian g'. Since $\alpha^2 = \beta^2 = 1$, $\alpha\beta$ has order 3 and $\beta\alpha = (\alpha\beta)^{-1}$, we get $g_\mathrm{B}(u) = (\alpha\beta)^3 = 1$ and $g_\mathrm{B}(v) = (\alpha\beta)^2(\alpha\beta)^{-1} = \alpha\beta \neq 1$. With $z = \$\mathtt{1234}$, Lemma 5.8 applies. For $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Ab}$, the proof of Lemma B.5 with an abelian group factor gives an abelian g'.

Consequences. If $s_\mathrm{A}(\Sigma_\mathrm{A}^+)$ were in $\mathbf{LI} \vee \mathbf{Grp}$, (iii) with $s' = s_\mathrm{A}$ would contradict (ii). Proposition 5.4 and its trivial-group and abelian cases assume a typing of the excluded kind. □

D Auxiliary Verification of Qualitative Reconstruction

Proof of Lemma 3.1. The identity holds because substitutions commute. By linearity and nondeletion each $\square_\kappa$ occurs exactly once in E_j, and by nonpermutation in the order $\kappa = 1, \ldots, d_j$, since E places $\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_{d_0}$ from left to right. Consider ξ_j^κ and $\xi_j^{\kappa+1}$. If both lie in one α_i, nonmerging puts a terminal or a variable $\xi_i^{\kappa'}$ with $i \neq j$ between them, which becomes a nonempty word. Otherwise they lie in $\alpha_i, \alpha_{i'}$ with $i < i'$, and the material between them contains the separator $v_i \in \Sigma^+$ of E. So every internal separator of E_j is nonempty. □

Proof of Lemma 3.2. Put $\vec{z}_j := \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_j, \vec{x}_{j+1}, \ldots, \vec{x}_r)$. For $E \in \mathcal{E}_{d_0}$, Lemma 3.1 gives an admissible E_j with $E[\vec{z}_{j-1}] = E_j[\vec{x}_j]$ and $E[\vec{z}_j] = E_j[\vec{u}_j]$; since $\vec{u}_j \equiv_{L,s} \vec{x}_j$, E accepts $\vec{z}_{j-1}$ iff it accepts $\vec{z}_j$. So $\mathcal{D}_L(\vec{z}_0) = \mathcal{D}_L(\vec{z}_r)$. The types agree because $\widehat{s}^{(d_0)}(\rho(\cdots)) = \mathrm{out}_\rho$ of the children's types. □

Proof of Proposition 3.10. Induction on the height of a derivation from $[\vec{x}]$. Const derives $\vec{x}$. Link $[\vec{x}] \to [\vec{y}]$ has same-type $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ with a common context in $K \subseteq L$, so $\vec{x} \equiv_{L,s} \vec{y}$ by substitutability;

combine with the hypothesis for $[\vec{y}]$. For Comp $[\vec{z}] \to \rho([\vec{u}_1], \ldots, [\vec{u}_r])$ with $\vec{z} = \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)$, the children derive tuples equivalent to the $\vec{u}_j$, and Lemma 3.2 transfers this to $\vec{z}$. For $\widehat{S} \to [(w)]$ with $w \in K \subseteq L$, a derived (v) satisfies $(v) \equiv_{L,s} (w)$, and $\square_1$ accepts (w), so $v \in L$; $\widehat{S} \to \varepsilon$ occurs only if $\varepsilon \in K \subseteq L$. The uncapped grammar is the case of cap $\|K\|_+$. □

Proof of Proposition 3.11. This is the argument of [15, Lemma 3] for the concrete grammar. Each $\iota(X)$ and each $\vec{z}_R := \rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q))$ for a typed rule $R : X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$ is observed, via $\chi(X)$. They have the same type (out_ρ of the children's types is the type of X) and the common context $\chi(X)$, so Link gives $[\iota(X)] \to [\vec{z}_R]$. If $q = 0$, Const gives $[\vec{z}_R] \to \vec{z}_R$; otherwise $(\vec{z}_R, \rho, (\iota(Y_j))_j)$ is a composition witness of rank $q \le r_G$ (and $q \le \|K\|_+$ by (3.1)), so Comp gives $[\vec{z}_R] \to \rho([\iota(Y_1)], \ldots, [\iota(Y_q)])$. By induction, $X \Rightarrow^*_{\widetilde{G}_0} \vec{u}$ implies $[\iota(X)] \Rightarrow^* \vec{u}$. For $w \in L(G) = L(\widetilde{G}_0)$ (Proposition 3.6(iii)) a successful derivation starts with a start link $\widetilde{S} \to X$; then $\chi(X) = \square_1$, so $\iota(X) = (w')$ with $w' \in K$, and Start gives $\widehat{S} \to [\iota(X)] \Rightarrow^* (w)$. □

Proof of Theorem 3.13. If $L \cap \Sigma^+ = \emptyset$, then $K = L \subseteq \{\varepsilon\}$ and Definition 3.4 gives the claim. Otherwise $\mathcal{F}_L \subseteq L$ is finite, Proposition 3.11 with $\iota = \omega$ (canonical tuples have the right type by Proposition 3.6(i)) gives $L \cap \Sigma^+ \subseteq L(\mathcal{B}(K))$, Proposition 3.10 gives $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) \subseteq L$, and $\varepsilon \in L(\mathcal{B}(K))$ iff $\varepsilon \in K$ iff $\varepsilon \in L$. Rank-preserving normalization gives the last sentence. □

Proof of Theorem 3.14 and Corollary 3.16. As in [14, Lemma 6]: an occurrence is a sample word with at most $2f$ cut positions, and a composition witness of rank $\le r_{\max}$ adds at most $2fr_{\max}$ more, so there are $(1 + \|K\|_+)^{O(fr_{\max})}$ candidate rules, each checked in polynomial time. Identification is the conservative-learner argument of [14, Corollary 1 and Theorem 1]: once the characteristic sample of Theorem 3.13 has appeared, every new hypothesis is correct, and an earlier hypothesis that is never changed is sound by Proposition 3.10 and complete because every later datum is generated by it. Membership is decidable in polynomial time for fixed f and $r_{\max}$ [14, Proposition 4]. None of this bounds the stage of convergence. □

E Proofs for Typed Witnesses and Characteristic Data

Proof of Proposition 3.6. At every rule application the morphism property gives

$$\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(A))}(\rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_r)) = \mathrm{out}_\rho(\widehat{s}^{(d_1)}(\vec{u}_1), \ldots, \widehat{s}^{(d_r)}(\vec{u}_r)).$$

Induction on height gives (i) and the existence and uniqueness of the lift in (ii), since each typed label is forced by its yield. Erasing labels gives $L(G^{\widehat{s}}) \subseteq L(G)$, (ii) gives the converse, and trimming keeps every rule of every successful derivation. For (iv), insert the terminal derivation at an occurrence of X in a successful derivation of $\widetilde{G}_0$: typed rules depend only on typed symbols, so the result is a successful derivation of $G^{\widehat{s}}$, and trimming retains all its rules. (A rule of $G^{\widehat{s}}$ whose child has no terminal derivation, such as $A_{(0)} \to \mathtt{a}B_{(0)}$ when B derives only words of another type, is not retained; it occurs in no terminal derivation.) □

Definitions 2.8, 3.4 and 3.5 apply verbatim with any finite-monoid morphism $q : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ in place of $\widehat{s}$ (tuple types being $q^{(d)}$); write $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,q}$ for the class. The class and the operator use types of nonempty components only, so they depend only on $q|_{\Sigma^+}$.

Lemma E.1 (Monoid implementations)**.** *Let $q : \Sigma^* \to \mathsf{N}$ be a finite-monoid morphism, $\mathsf{S}_0 := q(\Sigma^+)$ and $s_0 := q|_{\Sigma^+}$.*

(i) *On* $(\Sigma^+)^d$*, equality of* $q^{(d)}$*-,* $s_0^{(d)}$*- and* $\widehat{s_0}^{(d)}$*-values coincide. Hence* $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,q} = \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s_0}$*, and the operators built with* q *and with* $\widehat{s_0}$ *return the same grammar on every sample.*

(ii) *For every good MCFG* G*, the trimmed refinements of* G *under* q *and under* $\widehat{s_0}$ *coincide (the untrimmed ones need not); hence the same canonical tuples, contexts and witness words may be chosen.*

Proof. (i) The three maps agree on Σ^+. (ii) By ε-freeness and Proposition 3.6(i), every typed nonterminal of a successful derivation under either morphism is $A_{\mathbf{t}}$ with $\mathbf{t} \in \mathsf{S}_0^{\mathrm{fan}(A)}$, and every start link used is $\widetilde{S} \to S_{(m)}$ with $m \in \mathsf{S}_0$. For children indexed in S_0, each nonempty template component is evaluated in S_0 identically by both morphisms, so both refinements have the same rules among S_0-indexed symbols, which carry all successful derivations. □

Proof of Lemma 3.7. Take a successful typed derivation containing X and follow the path from the root to an occurrence of X, starting with $\square_1$; at each rule apply Lemma 3.1 with the (nonempty) sibling yields fixed. This gives $\chi(X) \in \mathcal{E}_d$, and replacing the X-subtree by any X-derivation gives a successful derivation of $\chi(X)[\vec{u}]$. If $\widetilde{S} \to X$ is a rule, take the path of length zero. □

Proof of Lemma 3.8. For $\vec{u}, \vec{v} \in L_X$, Proposition 3.6(i) gives equal types, $\chi(X)$ accepts both, and the arity is at most f; substitutability gives $\mathcal{D}_L(\vec{u}) = \mathcal{D}_L(\vec{v})$. □

Proof of Lemma 4.1. For a rule R with left-hand side A fix a successful derivation D_R of length $\theta_G(R)$ that uses R; it exists because G is reduced. By nondeletion every terminal written by R, and every component of the tuple produced at that occurrence of A, survives exactly once in the sentence. This gives (i), and (ii) because every productive A has a rule.

(iv) For $A = S$ take $\square_1$. Otherwise delete the A-subtree of D_R and put ordered holes in place of its components; iterating Lemma 3.1 along the path to the root (siblings have nonempty yields) shows $E_A \in \mathcal{E}_d$, and its fixed letters belong to the sentence of D_R. Inserting any A-derivation gives a successful derivation, so E_A accepts $L_A(G) \supseteq L_X$ (Proposition 3.6(i)). A typed nonterminal with a start link has the form $S_{\mathbf{t}}$, and $E_S = \square_1$. For derivationality, insert the erasure of any $\widetilde{G}_0$-derivation D_X from X into the hole; the unique lift of the resulting successful derivation (Proposition 3.6(ii)) labels every node by its nonterminal and the $\widehat{s}$-vector of its yield, as D_X does, so it contains D_X at the hole, and deleting that X-subtree leaves E_A.

(iii) Follow a shortest dependency path from S to A; it repeats no nonterminal, so its rules are distinct and differ from R. Complete every sibling on the path and every child of R by a shortest terminal tuple (length $\le t_G$) and apply R. The distinct rules used write at most $\|G\|$ terminals and have at most $\|G\|$ child occurrences, so the sentence has length at most $\|G\| + \|G\| t_G \le 2\|G\| \max\{1, t_G\}$. □

Proof of Lemma 4.2. (i) All components are nonempty because G is ε-free, so $s \preceq \lambda$ and Proposition 3.6(i) give $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}') = \widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\vec{u}) = \mathbf{t}$. By Proposition 3.6(ii) a G-derivation of $\vec{u}'$ lifts to a $G^{\widehat{s}}$-derivation from X, so $\vec{u}' \in L_X$ by Proposition 3.6(iv). For the second claim apply $(\mathrm{R}^{\lambda}_{\beta})$ to some $\vec{u} \in L_X \neq \emptyset$.

(ii) A word of W_ι is $\chi(X)[\iota(X)]$ or a rule word. The context has at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ fixed letters, a typed rule has the template of its source and so writes at most $\bar{\theta}_G$ letters (Lemma 4.1(i)), and there are at most $r_{\max}$ child tuples. There is one word per typed nonterminal and per typed rule.

(iii) Apply the typed rule to $\widetilde{G}_0$-derivations of the $\omega(Y_j) \in L_{Y_j}$, erase the labels, and insert the result into the successful G-derivation from which E_B was obtained. As in the proof of Lemma 4.1(iv), the unique lift contains the typed derivation at the hole, and every rule of a successful derivation of

$G^{\widehat{s}}$ is retained by the definition of $\widetilde{G}_0$. A start link $\widetilde{S} \to S_{\mathbf{t}}$ is used by the successful derivation of $\omega(S_{\mathbf{t}})$, of length at most b.

(iv) Since $\chi(X)$ accepts every tuple of L_X and $\iota(X)$ is equivalent to them, $\chi(X)[\iota(X)] \in L$. For a typed rule $X \to \rho(Y_1, \ldots, Y_q)$ and $\vec{u}_j \in L_{Y_j}$, Lemma 3.2 gives $\rho(\iota(Y_1), \ldots, \iota(Y_q)) \equiv_{L,s} \rho(\vec{u}_1, \ldots, \vec{u}_q) \in L_X$, so the rule word lies in L as well. Equivalent tuples have equal types, so $\widehat{s}^{(\mathrm{fan}(B))}(\iota(X)) = \mathbf{t}$ for $X = B_{\mathbf{t}}$. Hence Proposition 3.11 ($r_G \le r_{\max}$, and $\chi(S_{\mathbf{t}}) = E_S = \square_1$) and Proposition 3.10 give $L(\mathcal{B}(K)) \cap \Sigma^+ = L \cap \Sigma^+$ for every finite K with $\mathsf{W}_\iota \subseteq K \subseteq L$, for both operators; the Start rule handles ε. □

Proof of Theorem 4.3. Apply Lemma 4.2(ii),(iv) with $\iota = \omega$ and $b = t_{\mathrm{typ}}$, counting the non-start typed nonterminals and rules instead of using the upper bound $C_s(G)$. □

Proof of Proposition 4.6. Apply Lemma 4.5 to $L' = L^{\setminus m}$, which lies in $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ by Lemma 4.4, and, if $\varepsilon \in L$, to $L' = L \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$; the canonical operators have characteristic samples for both by Theorem 3.13. Distinct positive types demand distinct sample words, and a word of type m costs at least $\mu_m(L) + 1$. □

Proof of Proposition 4.7. All templates are nonempty and use each variable once in order, so G_n is good; it is reduced and generates Σ^+ via $S \to SS \mid \mathtt{a} \mid \mathtt{c}$. Each rule has a successful use of length at most 2: complete every A_i by $\mathtt{c}$ ($i \ge 1$) or $\mathtt{a}$ ($i = 0$). A yield of A_n has type 1 iff it contains no $\mathtt{c}$, so the unique yield of $(A_n)_{(1)}$ is $\mathtt{a}^{2^n}$, and $t_{\mathrm{typ}}(G_n, s_{\mathtt{c}}) \ge 2^n$; the typed rule $S_{(1)} \to (A_n)_{(1)}$ is retained (via $S \to A_n$), and every successful derivation using it has length at least 2^n. □

Proof of Corollary 4.8. $L_X \subseteq \mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$ gives $\tau \le t_{\mathrm{typ}}$. Apply Lemma 4.2(ii),(iv) with $\iota(X)$ a shortest tuple of $\mathrm{Cl}_{L,s}(X)$ and $b = \tau$, counting as in Theorem 4.3; $K := \mathsf{W}_\iota \cup (\{\varepsilon\} \cap L)$. Finally, for $m \in \mathsf{S}_L$ the typed start nonterminal $X = S_{(m)}$ has $\chi(X) = \square_1$, so $\square_1 \in \mathcal{D}_L(\iota(X))$; thus $\iota(X) = (v)$ with $v \in L$ and $s(v) = m$, and $\tau_X \ge \mu_m(L)$. □

F Details of the Good Normalization

The four conversions below give Proposition 3.12; each satisfies a tuple-language identity from which the size bound is read off. Correctness of the nondeleting and nonmerging conversions is standard [14,28,30]; the size bounds are not stated there and are derived here. For $\vec{w} = (w_1, \ldots, w_d)$ and nonempty $I \subseteq [d]$, $\pi_I(\vec{w})$ keeps the components indexed by I in order, $\sigma\vec{w}$ permutes components and $\psi(\vec{w})$ concatenates consecutive blocks of components; so $\|\pi_I(\vec{w})\|_1 \le \|\vec{w}\|_1 = \|\sigma\vec{w}\|_1 = \|\psi(\vec{w})\|_1$.

Lemma F.1 (Stagewise tuple languages)**.** *Let G_0 be a reduced f-MCFG of rank at most $r_{\max}$. Each conversion below preserves linearity, does not increase fan-out, rank or any template, and multiplies the numbers of nonterminals and rules by a factor depending only on f and $r_{\max}$.*

(a) Nondeletion *(construction (f3) in the proof of [28, Lemma 2.2]). Introduce A^I for nonempty $I \subseteq [\mathrm{fan}(A)]$. For $R : A \to \rho(B_1, \ldots, B_q)$ let J_j be the components of B_j used by the I-indexed outputs of ρ; keep these outputs, use $B_j^{J_j}$ if $J_j \neq \emptyset$ and omit B_j otherwise. The rules are nondeleting and $L_{A^I} = \pi_I(L_A(G_0))$.*

(b) Nonpermutation. *Decorate a fan-out-d nonterminal by $\sigma \in \mathfrak{S}_d$ (the symmetric group on $\{1, \ldots, d\}$), the child's permutation being determined by the order in which the parent template uses its variables. The decorated nonterminal generates σL_A.*

(c) Empty components. *Let* $\mathsf{Pat}(A)$ *be the set of support patterns of* L_A*, computed by saturation. For realizable child patterns, replace variables of empty components by* ε*, delete empty parent components, omit all-empty children, and introduce* A^I *for each nonempty* $I \in \mathsf{Pat}(A)$*. Then* $L_{A^I} = \pi_I\{\vec{u} \in L_A : \operatorname{supp}(\vec{u}) = I\}$*, the result is* ε*-free, and* $S^{\{1\}}$ *generates the nonempty part of the language.*

(d) Nonmerging *(construction in the proof of [14, Section 2.3, Lemma 1]). Decorate a nonterminal by a composition* ψ *of its fan-out, the child's composition being given by the maximal runs of its consecutive variables in the parent template. The decorated nonterminal generates the image* $\psi(L_A)$*.*

Stages (b)–(d) preserve the properties established by earlier stages.

Proof. (a) For any child tuples, $\pi_I(\rho(\vec{v}_1, \dots, \vec{v}_q)) = \rho^I((\pi_{J_j}\vec{v}_j)_{J_j \neq \emptyset})$; induction gives $\subseteq$, and for $\supseteq$ the omitted children are completed by terminal derivations, which exist because G_0 is reduced. There are at most 2^f copies of each nonterminal and rule. (b) Linearity and nondeletion make the child permutations well defined; induction gives σL_A. There are at most $f!$ copies. (c) Retained variables occur once and in order; induction gives the identity, and omitted all-empty children are completed by derivations of their empty pattern. A retained child B^J has only the components indexed by J, and each of them is used by the parent template exactly once and in the original order, so nondeletion and nonpermutation persist. There are at most 2^f patterns per nonterminal and $2^{f r_{\max}}$ choices per rule. (d) Nonpermutation makes the runs compatible with each child's order and nondeletion makes them cover its components; then $\rho^\psi(\psi_1(\vec{v}_1), \dots, \psi_q(\vec{v}_q)) = \psi(\rho(\vec{v}_1, \dots, \vec{v}_q))$, and induction gives the image identity (merging need not be injective, so no inverse-image claim is made). Concatenating nonempty components yields nonempty components, and each merged block of a child is used once and in order, so ε-freeness, nondeletion and nonpermutation persist. The size is linear for fixed $f, r_{\max}$ [14, Section 2.3, after Example 2]. □

Proof of Proposition 3.12. If $L(G_{\text{in}}) \cap \Sigma^+ = \emptyset$, take G_{good} to consist of the start symbol alone, with no rules; it is good and generates $\emptyset = L(G_{\text{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$. Otherwise apply (a)–(d) to the trimmed input and trim again. Each stage multiplies the size by a factor depending only on $f, r_{\max}$, so $\|G_{\text{good}}\| = O_{f,r_{\max}}(\|G_{\text{in}}\|)$, and $L(G_{\text{good}}) = L(G_{\text{in}}) \setminus \{\varepsilon\}$ by (c). If this language is nonempty, the final trimming leaves a reduced grammar, and trimming preserves goodness. □

G The Three-Letter Doubling Family

This appendix proves Proposition 7.1; the proof of (ii) adapts the deterministic-parser argument of [23, Appendix C]. Fix $n \geq 1$, and for $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ write $x \equiv y$ if $\{(u, v) : uxv \in L_n\} = \{(u, v) : uyv \in L_n\}$; this is a monoid congruence.

The parser. A *stack* is a word over $E_0, \dots, E_n$ and the closing markers $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i, \hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$ $(1 \leq i \leq n)$, with its top on the left; ε is the empty stack. For every stack $\mathcal{Z}$ and $1 \leq i \leq n$ the moves are

$$E_0\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{\mathtt{a}} \mathcal{Z}, \quad E_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{\mathtt{b}} E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i\mathcal{Z}, \quad E_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{\mathtt{c}} E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\mathcal{Z},$$
$$\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{\mathtt{b}} \mathcal{Z}, \quad \hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{\mathtt{c}} \mathcal{Z},$$

and there are no others; in particular no move leaves ε. Write $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}$ if reading w from $\mathcal{X}$ ends in $\mathcal{Y}$. Three properties are used.

(D1) *Determinism.* The top symbol and the letter determine the move, so every word acts as a partial map on stacks.

(D2) *Weight.* Give E_i weight 4^i and each marker weight 1, and let $\mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{X})$ be the total weight. Every move lowers wt, since $4^i > 2 \cdot 4^{i-1} + 1$; hence $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{X}$ only for $w = \varepsilon$.

(D3) *Locality.* Moves read and rewrite only the top symbol, and markers are only popped. Hence $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}$ implies $\mathcal{X}\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}\mathcal{Z}$. Conversely, if $\mathcal{X}_1 \neq \varepsilon$ and $\mathcal{X}_1\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}$, then either (a) the run reaches $\mathcal{Z}$: $w = w_1w_2$ with $\mathcal{X}_1 \xrightarrow{w_1} \varepsilon$ and $\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w_2} \mathcal{Y}$, so $\mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Y}) \leq \mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Z})$; or (b) it does not: $\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{Y}_1\mathcal{Z}$ with $\mathcal{X}_1 \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}_1 \neq \varepsilon$, so $\mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Y}) > \mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Z})$, and $\mathcal{Y}_1$ ends with the last symbol of $\mathcal{X}_1$ whenever that symbol is a marker. For fixed $\mathcal{Z}$, comparing $\mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Y})$ with $\mathrm{wt}(\mathcal{Z})$ decides the case.

A letter $\mathtt{b}$ or $\mathtt{c}$ both opens and closes, so a word need not act injectively on all stacks; injectivity holds on the *reachable* stacks, those $\mathcal{X}$ with $E_n \xrightarrow{u} \mathcal{X}$ for some u.

Lemma G.1. (i) *For $0 \leq i \leq n$ and every stack $\mathcal{Z}$, $E_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Z}$ if and only if $w \in L^{(i)}$.*

(ii) *Put $\mathcal{F}_i := \{E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i, \hat{\mathtt{b}}_i, \hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\}$. Every reachable stack is ε or $\mathcal{Y}F_{j+1}\cdots F_n$ with $F_i \in \mathcal{F}_i$ and $\mathcal{Y} \in \{E_j, \hat{\mathtt{b}}_j, \hat{\mathtt{c}}_j\}$ ($\mathcal{Y} = E_j$ with $0 \leq j \leq n$, or a marker with $1 \leq j \leq n$). Every word acts as a partial injection on reachable stacks.*

Proof. (i) A run $E_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Z}$ is in case (a) of (D3), since case (b) ends in $\mathcal{Y}_1\mathcal{Z} \neq \mathcal{Z}$; so $w = w_1w_2$ with $E_i \xrightarrow{w_1} \varepsilon$ and $\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{w_2} \mathcal{Z}$, and $w_2 = \varepsilon$ by (D2). With the lifting in (D3), it suffices to show $E_i \xrightarrow{w} \varepsilon$ iff $w \in L^{(i)}$, by induction on i. From E_0 only the $\mathtt{a}$-move applies, and ε admits none. For $i \geq 1$ the first letter is $\mathtt{b}$ or $\mathtt{c}$. After $\mathtt{c}$, the stack $E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$ must be emptied; case (a) of (D3) with $\mathcal{X}_1 = E_{i-1}$, $\mathcal{Z} = \hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$ splits the rest as zz' with $E_{i-1} \xrightarrow{z} \varepsilon$ and $z' = \mathtt{c}$. After $\mathtt{b}$, two such splittings of $E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$ give $z_1z_2\mathtt{b}$ with $E_{i-1} \xrightarrow{z_j} \varepsilon$.

(ii) The set of such stacks contains E_n and is closed under the moves: from $E_jF_{j+1}\cdots F_n$, $\mathtt{b}$ gives $E_{j-1}(E_{j-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_j)F_{j+1}\cdots F_n$ and $\mathtt{c}$ gives $E_{j-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_jF_{j+1}\cdots F_n$; popping the top leaves $F_{j+1}\cdots F_n$, which is ε or again of the stated form, a first frame $E_j\hat{\mathtt{b}}_{j+1}$ being read as $\mathcal{Y} = E_j$ followed by the frame $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_{j+1}$.

For injectivity it suffices to consider letters, since moves map reachable stacks to reachable stacks. A *frame product* is a stack $F_{i+1}\cdots F_n$ with $F_k \in \mathcal{F}_k$ (the empty stack if $i = n$). Each frame F_k contains exactly one marker, of index k, so a frame product determines i: it is n for ε and otherwise one less than the least marker index. In a frame product a symbol E is always followed by a marker $\hat{\mathtt{b}}$. The moves of a letter on reachable stacks, and the shape of their results, are:

Letter	Move (reachable source)	Result begins with	Source recovered from
$\mathtt{a}$	$E_0\mathcal{Z} \to \mathcal{Z}$	a frame product	$\mathcal{Z}$
$\mathtt{b}$, opening	$E_i\mathcal{Z} \to E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i\mathcal{Z}$	two symbols E	i and $\mathcal{Z}$ read off
$\mathtt{b}$, closing	$\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i\mathcal{Z} \to \mathcal{Z}$, $\mathcal{Z}$ a frame product	a marker, $E\hat{\mathtt{b}}$, or ε	i from $\mathcal{Z}$
$\mathtt{c}$, opening	$E_i\mathcal{Z} \to E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\mathcal{Z}$	E followed by $\hat{\mathtt{c}}$	i and $\mathcal{Z}$ read off
$\mathtt{c}$, closing	$\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\mathcal{Z} \to \mathcal{Z}$, $\mathcal{Z}$ a frame product	a marker, $E\hat{\mathtt{b}}$, or ε	i from $\mathcal{Z}$

In the closing rows $\mathcal{Z}$ is a frame product because a reachable stack with a marker $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$ or $\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$ on top is $\mathcal{Y}F_{i+1}\cdots F_n$ with $\mathcal{Y}$ that marker. For $\mathtt{b}$, an opening result begins with two symbols E and a closing result never does, since in a frame product a symbol E is followed by a marker; for $\mathtt{c}$, an opening result begins with $E\hat{\mathtt{c}}$, which never occurs in a frame product. So the openings and the closings of one letter have disjoint images, each row is injective by its last column, and every letter, hence every word, acts as a partial injection on reachable stacks. □

Lemma G.2. *If $\mathcal{X}$ is reachable, $w \in L^{(i)}$ and $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y}$, then $\mathcal{X} = E_i\mathcal{Y}$. Consequently $w \equiv w'$ for all $w, w' \in L^{(i)}$.*

Proof. Induct on i; for $i = 0$, $\mathtt{a}$ only pops E_0. Let $i \geq 1$; all stacks met are reachable. If $w = \mathtt{c}v\mathtt{c}$ with $v \in L^{(i-1)}$ and the first $\mathtt{c}$ opens E_j, the induction hypothesis for v at $E_{j-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_j\mathcal{Z}$ gives $j = i$, and the last $\mathtt{c}$ pops $\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$. If the first $\mathtt{c}$ pops a marker, the rest is ε or a product of frames; to read v it must begin with E_{i-1} by the induction hypothesis, so its first frame is $E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$, and after v the top is $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$, on which $\mathtt{c}$ has no move. If $w = \mathtt{b}v_1v_2\mathtt{b}$ and the first $\mathtt{b}$ opens E_j, the induction hypothesis gives $j = i$, the words v_1, v_2 pop the two copies of E_{i-1}, and the last $\mathtt{b}$ pops $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$. If the first $\mathtt{b}$ pops a marker, then as before v_1 leaves the top $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$, from which v_2 cannot be read by the induction hypothesis. For the consequence, if $uwv \in L_n$, the run $E_n \xrightarrow{u} \mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{w} \mathcal{Y} \xrightarrow{v} \varepsilon$ has $\mathcal{X} = E_i\mathcal{Y}$, and $E_i\mathcal{Y} \xrightarrow{w'} \mathcal{Y}$ by Lemma G.1(i); so $uw'v \in L_n$, and conversely. □

Lemma G.3 (Branch synchronization)**.** *Let $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{x} \mathcal{Y}$ and $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{y} \mathcal{Y}$, where x, y are nonempty and begin with different letters. Then $\mathcal{X} = E_i\mathcal{Z}$ for some $1 \leq i \leq n$ and stack $\mathcal{Z}$, and $x = wx'$, $y = w'y'$ with $w, w' \in L^{(i)}$, $\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{x'} \mathcal{Y}$ and $\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{y'} \mathcal{Y}$.*

Proof. Only a top E_i with $i \geq 1$ admits two different letters, namely $\mathtt{b}$ and $\mathtt{c}$. Say $x = \mathtt{c}x_0$ and $y = \mathtt{b}y_0$, so $E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{x_0} \mathcal{Y}$ and $E_{i-1}E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{y_0} \mathcal{Y}$. By (D3) both runs are in the same case. Case (b) is impossible: it would give $\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{Y}_1\mathcal{Z} = \mathcal{Y}_2\mathcal{Z}$ with $\mathcal{Y}_1$ ending in $\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i$ and $\mathcal{Y}_2$ in $\hat{\mathtt{b}}_i$. In case (a), $x_0 = x_1x'$ with $E_{i-1}\hat{\mathtt{c}}_i \xrightarrow{x_1} \varepsilon$ and $\mathcal{Z} \xrightarrow{x'} \mathcal{Y}$, so $w := \mathtt{c}x_1$ satisfies $E_i \xrightarrow{w} \varepsilon$ and $w \in L^{(i)}$ by Lemma G.1(i). The same argument gives $y = w'y'$. □

Proposition G.4. *If $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{x} \mathcal{Y}$ and $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{y} \mathcal{Y}$, then $x \equiv y$. Consequently L_n is Clark–Eyraud substitutable.*

Proof. Induct on $|x| + |y|$. If x or y is empty, then $\mathcal{X} = \mathcal{Y}$, and the other is empty by (D2). If $x = cx'$ and $y = cy'$ for a letter c, (D1) gives $\mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{c} \mathcal{X}'$ with $\mathcal{X}' \xrightarrow{x'} \mathcal{Y}$ and $\mathcal{X}' \xrightarrow{y'} \mathcal{Y}$, and induction applies. Otherwise Lemma G.3 gives $x = wx'$, $y = w'y'$; induction gives $x' \equiv y'$, Lemma G.2 gives $w \equiv w'$, and $\equiv$ is a congruence.

For the consequence, let $x, y \in \Sigma^+$ with $uxv, uyv \in L_n$. By (D1) and Lemma G.1(i) there are runs $E_n \xrightarrow{u} \mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{x} \mathcal{Y} \xrightarrow{v} \varepsilon$ and $E_n \xrightarrow{u} \mathcal{X} \xrightarrow{y} \mathcal{Y}' \xrightarrow{v} \varepsilon$; $\mathcal{Y}$ and $\mathcal{Y}'$ are reachable, so Lemma G.1(ii) gives $\mathcal{Y} = \mathcal{Y}'$, and $x \equiv y$. Letters outside $\{\mathtt{a}, \mathtt{b}, \mathtt{c}\}$ only have empty distributions. □

Proof of Proposition 7.1. (i) Every template is nonempty and uses each variable once; at fan-out one, nonpermutation and nonmerging are automatic. The grammar is reduced since $E_i \Rightarrow^* \mathtt{c}^i\mathtt{a}\mathtt{c}^i$. It has $n + 2$ nonterminals and rules of sizes 3 (start), 2 (base), 7 and 5 (the two rules of each level) (Definition 2.5), whence $\|G_n\| = 13n+7$. A shortest yield of E_i has length $2i+1$, and the levels above E_i add at least $2(n - i)$ letters, attained by the rules $E_j \to \mathtt{c}E_{j-1}\mathtt{c}$. So the start, base and unary rules have rule thickness $2n + 1$, and the binary rule of level i has $2(n - i) + 2 + 2(2i - 1) = 2n + 2i$; hence $\bar{\theta}_{G_n} = 4n$.

(ii) The first claim is Proposition G.4. It is the condition of Definition 2.8 at $f = 1$ for the trivial typing, and the finite language L_n is a 1-MCFL; item (a) after Definition 2.8 gives $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s}$.

(iii) A derivation yields a word without $\mathtt{c}$ iff it uses no rule $E_i \to \mathtt{c}E_{i-1}\mathtt{c}$. Such a derivation from E_i is the complete binary tree of height i and yields W_i, and $|W_i| = 2|W_{i-1}| + 2$ with $|W_0| = 1$.

(iv) By (ii), $L_n \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{1,s_U}$, and by (iii), $1 \in \mathsf{S}_{L_n}$ with $\mu_1(L_n) = |W_n|$. Proposition 4.6 with $m = 1$ forces a word of type 1, which can only be W_n. □

H The Linear Factor at Every Fan-Out

This appendix proves Proposition 6.1. Ψ denotes the Parikh map.

Proof of Proposition 6.1. Put $t := 2f$ and $L := L^{(f)}_{q,n}$.

(i) The language $R := \mathtt{a}_1^*\mathtt{d}_1\mathtt{a}_2^*\mathtt{d}_2\cdots\mathtt{a}_t^*\mathtt{d}_t\mathtt{z}^*$ is the path language from 0 to t of the graph on $\{0,\dots,t\}$ with edges $\mathtt{a}_h : h-1 \to h-1$, $\mathtt{d}_h : h-1 \to h$ and $\mathtt{z} : t \to t$, and a word of R is determined by its Parikh vector. In w_i the marker $\mathtt{d}_h$ occurs once, at position $h(i+1)$, so the position of one marker, and the distance $(h'-h)(i+1)$ of two, determine i; all words have length W.

Let $J \subseteq L$ and $1 \le d \le f$, let $\vec{x}, \vec{y}$ be nonempty d-tuples and $E = (v_0,\dots,v_d)$ a d-context with $E[\vec{x}] = w_i \in J$ and $E[\vec{y}] = w_j \in J$, and let F be a d-context with $F[\vec{x}] \in J$. We show $F[\vec{y}] \in J$; the converse is symmetric. By Lemma 3.17, $F[\vec{y}] \in R$. If $i = j$, then $\sum_h \Psi(x_h) = \sum_h \Psi(y_h)$, so $F[\vec{y}]$ has the Parikh vector of $F[\vec{x}]$ and equals it. Let $i \ne j$. A marker in v_0 would have the same position in w_i and w_j, a marker in v_d the same distance from the end, and two markers in one v_h the same distance; each forces $i = j$. So the fixed part of E carries at most $d-1$ markers, and $\vec{x}$ carries at least $t - d + 1 \ge d + 1$ of them. Some component x_h carries two, and every word of L with factor x_h is w_i. Hence $F[\vec{x}] = w_i = E[\vec{x}]$, the fixed parts of F and E have equal Parikh vectors, $\Psi(F[\vec{y}]) = \Psi(E[\vec{y}])$, and $F[\vec{y}] = w_j \in J$. Finite languages are context-free, and the inclusion is item (a) after Definition 2.8.

(ii) For each i, $L \setminus \{w_i\} \in \mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{mcf}}_{f,s}$ by (i), so every characteristic sample contains w_i by Lemma 4.5. Hence $F = L$. Conversely, $K = L$ is the only finite K with $L \subseteq K \subseteq L$, and the canonical operators return L on it by sample consistency and soundness.

(iii) Take nonterminals $P_0,\dots,P_q$ of fan-out f and $S_0,\dots,S_q$, $C_0,\dots,C_n$ of fan-out one, start symbol S_q, and the rules

$$P_0 \to (\mathtt{d}_1, \mathtt{d}_3, \dots, \mathtt{d}_{2f-1}), \qquad C_0 \to (\mathtt{z}), \qquad C_h \to (\xi^1_1\xi^1_2)(C_{h-1}, C_{h-1})\ (1 \le h \le n),$$
$$P_i \to (\mathtt{a}_1\xi^1_1\mathtt{a}_2,\ \mathtt{a}_3\xi^2_1\mathtt{a}_4,\ \dots,\ \mathtt{a}_{2f-1}\xi^f_1\mathtt{a}_{2f})(P_{i-1})\ (1 \le i \le q),$$
$$S_j \to (\xi^1_1\mathtt{d}_2\xi^2_1\mathtt{d}_4\cdots\xi^f_1\mathtt{d}_{2f}\xi^1_2)(P_j, C_n)\ (0 \le j \le q), \qquad S_j \to (\xi^1_1\mathtt{z}^{2f})(S_{j-1})\ (1 \le j \le q).$$

By induction $L(C_h) = \{\mathtt{z}^{2^h}\}$,

$$L(P_i) = \{(\mathtt{a}^i_1\mathtt{d}_1\mathtt{a}^i_2, \dots, \mathtt{a}^i_{2f-1}\mathtt{d}_{2f-1}\mathtt{a}^i_{2f})\}, \qquad L(S_j) = \{\mathtt{a}^i_1\mathtt{d}_1\cdots\mathtt{a}^i_{2f}\mathtt{d}_{2f}\mathtt{z}^{2f(j-i)+2^n} : 0 \le i \le j\},$$

so $L(S_q) = L$. Every variable occurs once and in order, consecutive components of P_j are separated by $\mathtt{d}_2, \mathtt{d}_4, \dots$, and no component is empty; so the grammar is good, and it is reduced. It has $2q + n + 3$ nonterminals and $1, q, q+1, q, 1, n$ rules of sizes $f+1$, $3f+2$, $2f+4$, $2f+3$, 2, 5 for P_0, P_i, the first and second rules of S_j, C_0 and C_h (Definition 2.5); this gives the stated size, and $n \le q$ gives $(7f+17)(q+1)$. In a reduced presentation every rule occurs in a successful derivation and all words have length W, so $\bar{\theta}_G = W$. Finally let G be any reduced good fan-out-$\le f$ presentation of L. For the trivial typing, Theorem 3.13 makes $\mathsf{W}(\widetilde{G}_0)$ characteristic for $\mathcal{B}_{f,s_{\mathrm{triv}}}$, and it has at most $|V| + |P| \le \|G\|$ words (Definition 3.9 and the remark after Theorem 4.3); by (ii) for s_{triv}, it has $q+1$ words. The final estimate follows from (ii), (iii) and $|w_i| = W$.

(iv) The identification changes no length and no template shape, so the grammar stays reduced and good with the same size and thickness, and the arguments for (ii) and (iii) apply unchanged once (i) is shown. For (i), let $J \subseteq L$, and let $u\,x\,v = w_i \in J$ and $u\,y\,v = w_j \in J$ with $x, y \in \Sigma^+$; if $i = j$ then $x = y$. Let $i \ne j$. All words have length W. If u contained $\mathtt{d}$, the first $\mathtt{d}$ would have position $i+1$ in w_i and $j+1$ in w_j; if v contained $\mathtt{d}$, the last $\mathtt{d}$ would be followed by $2(q-i)+2^n$ and by $2(q-j)+2^n$ letters. So x contains both letters $\mathtt{d}$ of w_i and has the factor $\mathtt{da}^i\mathtt{d}$, which occurs in no other word of L and only once in w_i. Hence $p\,x\,q' \in J$ forces $(p, q') = (u, v)$, and then $p\,y\,q' = w_j \in J$; the converse is symmetric. □

Declaration of generative AI and AI-assisted technologies in the manuscript preparation process

During preparation of this work, the author used ChatGPT (OpenAI) and Claude (Anthropic) to assist with organization of the manuscript, expression and translation of text, cross-checks of references and notation, and editing of LaTeX source, and also to assist with exploring and checking proof approaches and with pre-submission reviewing. The author checked all mathematical content. After using these tools, the author reviewed and edited the material as needed and takes full responsibility for the content of the publication.

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